

SUNDAY 30 AUGUST 2026

Twenty Second Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 31 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 1 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 2 Sept			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 3 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 4 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 5 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm: <i>First Anniversary, Isobel Coyle</i>	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 6 Sept	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 13 & 27 Sept</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Please note that Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament resumes this week in Aghyaran and Castlederg, on 3 and 4 September respectively, as above. Liturgy of the Word will resume the following week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £865 & €10. Church Restoration Fund: £809 & €77.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,220 & €136, made up of:

Castlederg £1,413 & €80, Drumnabey £453 & €36, Dregish £354. **DRUMQUIN:** £608.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: The August draw will take place after Mass in Dregish this Sunday. Good luck to everyone.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Gerry O'Kane, Dooish Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Thursday, and Danny O'Donnell, Meenamullin Road, Killeter, whose Funeral Mass took place in Aghyaran on Friday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are returning to school this week or are starting school for the first time. We continue to remember in prayer all who are preparing to commence third-level education at this time and those who are taking up employment for the first time. **May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You.**

- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER** lifted the Bible with the intention of reading it....but maybe just managed a few pages, before giving up in vain?
- ♦ **DID YOU KNOW** that the Bible is not actually a book? It is a Library - of 73 books.
- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER THOUGHT ABOUT** how the books of the Bible fit together – move along a timeline - to reveal God's plan for our salvation?
- ♦ **WOULD YOU LIKE TO GAIN** a deeper knowledge and understanding of the Bible so that, when reading or listening to the Scripture readings at Mass on Sunday, you will have a much clearer understanding of them and of how they apply to our everyday lives?

It is our aim over the next number of weeks to **take the 'mystery' out of the Bible** and to give us all a whole new understanding and love of God's Word. In **St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg**, we are going to run an eight-week Bible Study course called **"Unlocking the mysteries of the Bible."** It will take place over the course of **eight Wednesday evenings, commencing 9 September, from 7.30 – 9.00pm**. This course is presented by renowned Catholic speaker Jeff Cavins who, through engaging video presentations and his acclaimed **Bible Timeline** approach, will literally unlock the mystery of the Bible for us.

There will be opportunity for small-group discussion, with the aid of a workbook, with which you will be provided. There is a suggested donation of £15, which will include your workbook, a colour-coded Bible Timeline Card which will be a useful tool as we move along the 'timeline' of the course. Refreshments will be provided.

You can book for the course in advance via Fr Paul / the Parish Office or just come along and enrol on Wednesday 9 September. Let us unlock the mystery of the Bible together. Everyone is welcome.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 31 Aug: Dregish, commencing at 11.00am. **Thursday 3 Sept:** Corgary, Tullicar, Aghyaran, Killeter, Scraghey, Coolcreaghy, Shanog Road, Laghel Road, commencing after 10.00am Mass – Fr Paul. **Friday 4 Sept:** Garvagh, The Laghts, Lisnacloon, Magheranageeragh, Mullinabreen, Trienamongan, commencing 11.00am – Fr Paul.

LORETO GRAMMAR SCHOOL, OMAGH: Arrangements for School Opening: Years 9, 10 & 11 only – Tue 1 Sept; Years 8 & 12 only – Wed 2 Sept; Years 13 & 14 only – Thurs 3 Sept; All pupils – Fri 4 Sept.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie. Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY: Annual National Mass, Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions start back next Friday, 4 September, at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – this Friday, 4 September, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOYORCYCLES will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLi Station, to present the donation to the RNLi.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

SUNDAY, 30TH AUGUST 2026

22ND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Faith • Prayer • Community

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 16:21–27

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of **surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love**.

Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice.

Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection

True **PROFIT** is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is:

P — Pursuing God's purpose

R — Rejecting empty paths

O — Offering our lives

F — Following faithfully

I — Investing in what lasts

T — Treasuring our souls

When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind, so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.

Prayer for a New School Year

We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave.

During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. **Amen.**

Saints of the Coming Week

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Season of Creation

1st September – 4th October

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This year's theme, '**Living Water**', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

You are warmly invited to the streaming of World Council of Churches online service marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on **Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm** at **The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU.**

For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com

RSVP: 07711900420.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.

All welcome.

Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN** for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

All welcome.



Padre Pio Prayer Group

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on **Tuesday 1st September**, starting with Rosary at **6.45 pm**, celebration of Mass at **7.15 pm** followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Visit: derryvocations.org



Donegal Group 173 – Rise and Shine Trust

Celebrating 40 Years

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating **40 years** of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter.

We are celebrating with a special Mass on **Saturday 26th September at 12 noon** in the **Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny**.

Mass will be concelebrated by **Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown** and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years.

We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: loughderg.org

All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino

A Day of Pilgrimage, Prayer, Brotherhood and Renewal

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner)

Visit: dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

Join us on **Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm** at **Murphy's on the Green**.

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity – Sacristan

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour

For application pack, please contact:

Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Telephone: 028 71262302

Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary

The September Men's Rosary will take place on **Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm** at **Market Square, Letterkenny**.

Everyone welcome.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September

For the Care of Water

You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention:

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run

The **Pink Colour Fun Run** takes place at **Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October**.

Details available at **cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run**

† Faith • Hope • Community

Please remember in your prayers all those who are sick, bereaved, lonely or in need, and all those who have asked for our prayers.

PARISH OF BANAGHER

22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time – 30th August 2026

Mass Times Mass

Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 6th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil; 9.15am
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

Baptism We welcome into God's family Callin Niall McLaughlin.

A Month's Mind Mass will be celebrated for Celestine O'Kane, RIP, at St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn on Saturday 5th September at 7.00pm.

Prayer for Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Blessing of the Graves 2026

The Blessing of the Graves at St. Mary's Church, Altinure will take place next **Sunday 6th September after 10.30am Mass**. Please bring a small container of water to the Ceremony of the Blessing of the Graves. This water will be blessed during the Ceremony. A member of each family will be invited to sprinkle holy water on the grave after the prayers of blessing over all the graves have been recited by the priest.

September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	Natalie McCloskey	Mary Kathleen McDermott	Noeleen McGlinchey
Eucharistic Ministers	Bernie Lynch	Geraldine McCloskey	Andrena O'Kane
Flowers	Bridget Kealey		Briege McLaughlin
Cleaning	Margaret Cartin, Angela Hasson		Audrey McElhinney, Martina Moore
Counters	Ann Hassan, Marian & Anthony O'Neill, Patricia McCloskey		Philomena Conway, Sean Conway, Karen Feeney
Collectors	Dermot Lynch Vincent McCloskey	Anthony O'Neill Patrick McGrellis	Eamon Feeney, Patrick Conway

The Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry will take place on Tuesday 1st September, starting with Rosary at 6.45pm. Celebration of Mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. Everyone welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Blessing of Motorcycles on Sunday 13th September at St. Aengus' Church, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are very welcome. All money raised will be donated to the RNLI Station at Ned's Point, Buncrana.

Banagher Parish Monthly Cash Prize Draw ~ Tickets on Sale!

✠ Money raised will go towards the ongoing refurbishment and ✠
 ✠ maintenance of our Churches ✠

Draws for 10 Cash Prizes will take place in **October, November and December**. 30 chances to win! Tickets cost **£30** and are now on sale and available from our Church Sacristies and Parochial House and from Feeny Spar, Park Vivo, Mace Derrychrier and Sperrin View Bar. Thank you very much for your support.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, and at the Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

22nd & 23rd August 2026

St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £1,095 St Mary's Church, Altinure: £950

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:

Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659

Thank you for your continued generosity.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) is celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny, Co. Donegal at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Feast Days this Week

Thursday 3rd September: St. Gregory the Great, also known as Pope Gregory I, was born in 540 AD into a noble Roman family. Gifted with intelligence and deep faith, he first pursued a successful career in government, becoming Prefect of Rome, yet he longed for a life of prayer and simplicity. He converted his family's villa into a monastery and lived as a monk, dedicating himself to study, service and contemplation. In 590, during a time of famine and plague, Gregory was chosen as Pope. He became one of the most influential leaders in Church history. He reformed Church administration, organized relief for the poor, promoted missionary activity and restructured the liturgy, giving rise to the singing style we now call 'Gregorian Chant'. Known for his humility, pastoral care and tireless work for both the spiritual and material welfare of his flock, Gregory earned the title 'The Great'. He died in 604 and was declared a Doctor (Teacher) of the Church.

Saturday 5th September: St. Teresa of Calcutta (1910 – 1997) Agnes Gonxha Bojaxhiu was born into an Albanian family on 26th August 1910 at Skopje in Macedonia. She left home at the age of 18 to join the Sisters of Loreto in Ireland, where she received the name Sister Mary Teresa, after St. Thérèse of Lisieux. In 1931 she was assigned to the order's Calcutta house in Indi and taught at their school there, where she eventually became headmistress. She later received a new vocation to help the poor and destitute, and in 1948, obeying this call, she left the convent and took up a new life caring for them wherever they might be, lying sick in the street or even dying in dustbins. Mother Teresa radiated light for those in need. Some of her former pupils joined her, one by one, and the new congregation of the Missionaries of Charity was established in the Diocese of Calcutta in 1950, spreading across India and eventually onto every continent. Mother Teresa of Calcutta died on 5th September 1997. She was beatified by Pope John Paul II on 19th October 2003 and canonized St. Teresa of Calcutta by Pope Francis on 4th September 2016.

JOB OPPORTUNITY

Derry Diocesan Trust: Sacristan

Hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St. John the Baptist Church, Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs, please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St. Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than **12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026**.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Privacy Notice - The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

COMMUNITY NEWS

Dungiven and Feeny local committee for Cancer Research UK would like to thank everyone who supported and helped in any way with our 'Dungiven Walk of Hope 2026'. The walk raised the amazing sum of £8,780.01! Thank you everyone for your continued support.

Learmount Community Development Group: To book any of our classes, trips and workshops or for further information, contact Karen or Min on 028 7778 1881 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org. The Learmount Group would like to thank the amazing volunteers who gave up their time over the summer to help clean up and improve Park Village. We are truly blessed and grateful for all the help that was received.

The Parish Webcams are now available to view on the Firestick. If you search for the iTech Media App and download it to your Firestick, you can then search for the Church.

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Parish Office opening hours next week: Tuesday to Friday: 9.30am - 12.30pm.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com
SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973

Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week’s collection totalled €6,052 <i>Sincere thanks.</i>	Priest on Call 074 9361253	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Walsh 9361393 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9361253 Parish Catechist 086 785 3726	PARISH DRAW <u>Friday 21August: Week 10</u> 1st Prize: €500 Teishie Doherty (Conn), c/o Promoter <i>Promoter: Mary McGonagle</i> 2nd Prize: €300 Claire McCarron, Tullydish <i>Promoter: Mary McGonagle</i> 3rd Prize: €150 The Hutchinson Family, Cluain Mhuire <i>Promoter: Helen Doherty</i>	BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com Harry Potter And The Philosopher’s Stone 25th Anniversary Sat 29th - 8:15pm Sun 30th -5pm Paw Patrol: Dino Movie G 88mins Sat 29th - 5pm Sun 30th Sensory Screening - 11am Matinee Sunday 30th - 3pm National Theatre -All My Sons Sun 30th & Mon 31st 8:15pm Tickets €12 cash only at door Holy Days 12A 100mins Tues 1st - 8:15pm Wed 2nd & Thurs 3rd - 8:15pm Movies & Tea Holy Days - Tues 1st Sept 1-4pm Adm €10 Followed by Afternoon tea Carers go free	St Mary’s Hall Fridays at 8pm Single book €1 Double €17 Snowball: €5050
Anniversary Masses & Times <u>ST MARY’S ORATORY</u> Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana Monday 31 Aug - Mass at 10am Noel Bradley (3rd A), plus Bridie Bradley (10th A) Tuesday 1 Sept - Mass at 10am Betty McDaid (1st A) Wednesday 2 Sept - Mass at 10am Diane Hurley (5th A) Thursday 3 Sept - Mass at 10am Saturday 5 Sept - Mass at 4:30pm Mary McGonagle (2nd A), John Martin (2nd A), plus James and Mary-Ann Martin Sunday 6 Sept - Mass at 8:30am Sunday 6 Sept - Mass at 12:30pm Liam Grant (MM)	<u>GARDEN FETE THANKS</u> The Garden Fête 2026 was a lovely success due to the help and support of a tremendous number of people, some of whom are mentioned herewith and many of whom are anonymous. Those who baked and bought tickets, those who sold raffle lines and secured sponsorship, those who helped in so many ways on the day itself – to say nothing of those who turned out in great numbers to give their support on the day. Our sincere thanks to the businesses and individuals who gave sponsorship and prizes – your generosity is noted and appreciated. Sincere thanks to Scoil Mhuire for the use of their facilities. A great “thank you” to all concerned and to those in the Parish Office and those who attended the meetings and who were in the eye of the storm. Hopefully, such a lovely experience and expression of who we are as a Parish can be repeated again in the years to come. Our crowds were smaller than in other years, but we hope that there is still good support for this initiative. We thank God too for the lovely weather we all enjoyed. <i>Father Bradley</i>	<u>ADORATION CHAPEL</u> Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel Sunday 2pm - 10pm Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm Friday 6am - 10pm	<u>LEGION OF MARY</u> Pilgrimage to Knock on Sunday 27 September leaving from Buncrana. More details to follow <u>FIRST SATURDAY ROSARY</u> Sat 5 Sept at 1pm in Market Square, Letterkenny. Please bring a friend or two. <u>MEN’S ROSARY</u> Sat 5 Sept at 1pm in The Square, Malin Town All welcome <u>BUNCRANA PANTOMIME SOCIETY</u> Are calling all children aged 7-12 to audition for this year’s production of Robinson Crusoe on Sat 5 Sept in St Mary’s Hall, Buncrana from 12noon-2pm. Come along and showcase your talent. Looking forward to seeing you all there. <u>CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY</u> Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sun 6 Sept at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry . The day will begin with Mass at 2pm , celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown , followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For info and booking, please email info@catholicmothers.ie . All welcome. <u>COFFEE MORNING</u> for the Niall Mellon Township Trust on Sat 5th Sept 10am to 2pm in The Fowler Hall Tooban. All proceeds will help raise funds to support Paul Bradley, Gerard Curran, Kieran Toner and Oisin Bradley to travel to South Africa with the Niall Mellon Township Trust to help build a school for impoverished children. Everyone welcome. <u>DONEGAL GROUP</u> 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Sat 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown, Diocese of Derry, and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes. <u>ANAM CARA</u> Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on Thur 10th Sept at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15.	<u>SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE</u> Yoga class starting on Mon 7 Sept at 7pm. To book a place contact Marie on 0872962646. Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back on Wed 9 September. (Sewing /Embroidery/ Knitting) no tutor, just a group of like minded people supporting each other while enjoying a cup of tea and a chat, bring your own materials and sewing machine. €3 per class, contact the centre on 0749361742 for more info. Free Smart-phone & Tablet course starting Tues 22 Sept from 10:30 -12:30, to book contact the centre on 0749361742. <u>THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY</u> Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept ‘no’, listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up. <u>ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS</u> Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. <u>AL-ANON GROUP</u> (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. <u>GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS</u> weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. <u>GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE</u> Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. <u>THE PLAZA Dance Classes</u> starting back on Tues 25 August from 10:30am. From Wed 26 August: Junior Line Dancing & Jiving Class 5pm-6pm. Beginners Line Dancing 6:15pm-7:15pm. Advanced Line Dancing 7:30pm-8:30pm. From Mon 31 Aug: A Beginners Line Dancing and Jiving Class at the Laurentic 7:30pm -9pm. Social Dances: Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 <u>INISHOWEN MEDICAL</u> Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. <u>BEGINNER PIANO LESSONS</u> available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. <u>BRIDGE CLASSES</u> starting Wed 23 Sept in Buncrana Youth Club. For details contact John 0870562188 or Mary 086060858	<u>SLIMMING WORLD Buncrana: The Exchange</u> every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall every Thurs at 6pm with Marie 0877389059. Newtowncunningham: The Orange Hall every Wed at 6.30pm with Ann Marie 0860848705. GET THE GRADE English Tuition. Friendly, exam-focused, Junior & Leaving Cert tuition with experienced teacher of English & SEC Examiner (Teaching Council and Garda vetted). Text/Call Mark 0866655334 <u>INISHOWEN INJURY CLINIC</u> Treatment of back, neck and shoulder pain / sports injuries / rehabilitation. Contact Cahir McLaughlin NMT, Maginn Ave 0860753296 <u>HEALTH & WELLBEING PARK RUN</u> Come and join our community of walkers, runners and volunteers every Sat at 9.15am by the shore front play park. All welcome <u>GENTLE EXERCISE CLASS</u> for people living with Parkinson's every Wed at 2pm in The Exchange. <u>COCKHILL CEILI CLUB</u> Classes have now stopped for the summer months. <u>CEILI</u> in Cockhill School Hall Fri 4 Sept. Music by Martin. Dancing from 8pm-11pm. Adm €10 incl Supper and Raffle tickets. All welcome <u>GAELSCOIL BHUN CRANNCHA</u> Give us a call on 074 9361988 or an email at gsbc1999@gmail.com to discuss how an Irish medium education can benefit your child. If you don’t speak Irish, don’t worry. That won’t hold your child back. <u>COMMUNITY EMPLOYMENT PROGRAMME</u> <u>VACANCIES</u> for a grounds worker for the graveyard at St Mary’s Cockhill. Contact buncrana@swillycep.ie for more info or application. <u>DOG FREE ZONE</u> A reminder that dogs are not permitted in Cockhill or Desertegney graveyards. Thank you. <u>SCOIL TRAD BHUN CRANNCHA</u> (School of Irish Traditional Music). Lessons for children (7+); Tin Whistle, Bodhrán, Accordion, Banjo, Mandolin, Fiddle. Registration on Wed 2 Sept 6 -7pm, Buncrana Youth Club, Castle Ave. Contact: Jim Woods on 087 4186082 (Classes start back 9 Sept) <u>GENTLE HATHA YOGA CLASS</u> beginning on 7 Sept at 7pm in Angler’s Centre. Contact Anne Nelson 086 2586864 for further information. <u>SAMARITANS</u> Call Free 116 123 , Text 087 2609090 . <u>NOWDOC</u> Phone Number: 0818400911
<u>STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY</u> Masses streamed on www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish Sundav 6 Sept - Mass at 9:45am	<u>READINGS FOR 22ND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME</u> 1st Reading: Jer 20: 7-9. The prophet Jeremiah lived through the siege of Jerusalem (600 BC), the destruction of the Temple and deportations to Babylon. His prophesying urged a shift from outward practices to a person-to-person, relational, heartfelt religion. For this he was ridiculed and imprisoned. ‘The prophet here foreshadows Christ on the eve of his passion: the living word of God had lit a similar consuming fire deep in Jeremiah’s heart.’ 2nd Reading: Rm 12:1-2. Merely external, outward practice is not acceptable. Our behaviour has to spring from a whole new mind, offering ourselves in all things like Jesus, ‘as a holy sacrifice pleasing to God.’ Gospel: Mt 16: 21-27. Back in 1994 at the Maynooth launch of the Catechism of the Catholic Church Cardinal Desmond Connell described and explained how Jesus will proudly wear the wounds of his Passion for all eternity. Christians should accept their cross just as Christ did	<u>ROSARY</u> The Rosary is said in the Oratory at 9.30am before Mass Monday to Thursday.	<u>PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS</u> That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by re-nouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.	<u>ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS</u> Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. <u>AL-ANON GROUP</u> (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. <u>GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS</u> weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. <u>GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE</u> Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. <u>THE PLAZA Dance Classes</u> starting back on Tues 25 August from 10:30am. From Wed 26 August: Junior Line Dancing & Jiving Class 5pm-6pm. Beginners Line Dancing 6:15pm-7:15pm. Advanced Line Dancing 7:30pm-8:30pm. From Mon 31 Aug: A Beginners Line Dancing and Jiving Class at the Laurentic 7:30pm -9pm. Social Dances: Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 <u>INISHOWEN MEDICAL</u> Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. <u>BEGINNER PIANO LESSONS</u> available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. <u>BRIDGE CLASSES</u> starting Wed 23 Sept in Buncrana Youth Club. For details contact John 0870562188 or Mary 086060858	
<u>BAPTISMS</u> We welcome into God’s Family the following children who were recently baptised: Adam Neil Patrick Moran Annie Moran Rosie Méabh Lavery Watson <i>May God guide and protect our children always.</i>		<u>THE PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP.</u> Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty on Tues 1 Sept. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass at 7.15pm, the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. Everyone Welcome	<u>BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES</u> takes place on Sun 13 Sept in St Aengus’ Chapel, Burt at 1:30pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned’s Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sun 13 Sept in St Patrick’s Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.		
<u>DEATH</u> Your prayers are asked for Charlie Campbell who was buried during the week and for his family and friends saddened by their loss.		<u>GUIDED HOLY HOUR</u> The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary’s Oratory. All Welcome.	<u>BLESSING AT THE FRONT DOOR FOR THE FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL</u> Heavenly Father, as we close the door to our home to begin our journey, we ask you to bless (children’s name/s) on their first day back to / of school. We ask you to open the doors of new hope, new possibilities, new friendships and new learning for them. Bless their teachers, friends and all the staff of the school. Be with them in all they will do this year. Protect them and keep them safe until they return through this door to the home where they are cherished and loved. We make this prayer through Christ our Lord. Amen		
<u>SVP PILGRIMAGE TO KNOCK</u> The Vincentian Pilgrimage to Knock will take place on Sat 12 Sept. The cost per person is €55. This includes travel by bus, breakfast and dinner in The Central Hotel, Donegal Town. If you would like to book a seat, contact Fiona on 0863517177 by 25 August.	<u>SEASON OF CREATION 2026</u> The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year’s theme, <i>Living Water</i> , invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God’s creation. To mark the beginning of the season, the Three Patrons Parish Laudato Si’ group are inviting people to a short prayer service on Tues 1 Sept at 6:30pm in St Joseph’s Church, Galliagh. All are welcome				
<u>ONE DAY PILGRIMAGE TO LOUGH DERG</u> The Parish is running a one-day pilgrimage to Lough Derg on Sat 5 Sept. Bus leaving The Oratory at 7:30am for arrival at the island at 9:30am. Cost for the day including return bus, boat fare, day pilgrimage and meal on way home is €85. For more info and booking please contact the Parish Office. Spaces on a first-come first-served basis.	<u>CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS, SCALP</u> Sun 30 Aug meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm. The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome.				
PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary’s Oratory and St Mary’s Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary’s Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary’s Cockhill.					

**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-Second Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 30th August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 16:21-27)

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love. Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice. Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection.

True PROFIT is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is **Pursuing** God's purpose, **Rejecting** empty paths, **Offering** our lives, **Following** faithfully, **Investing** in what lasts, and **Treasuring** our souls. When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

***May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind,
so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 2nd September at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Feast of St Pio – Wednesday 23rd September To celebrate the feast of St Pio, a triduum of prayer will take place in the parishes of our pastoral area on days beforehand – more details next week. Mass to celebrate the feast day will take place on Wednesday 23rd September at 7 pm in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am - 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd.** Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am - 1.00 pm.** Everyone welcome.

We wish every blessing on all the students, teachers and school staff of our parish pastoral area, as they return to school. God bless for the year ahead.

Prayer for a New School Year We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days. As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave. During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. Amen.

Requiescat in Pace Martin Gallagher, Bingley, Yorkshire (formerly of Laurel Drive)

Anniversaries Margaret Connolly, Dympna Coyle, Edward Crawford, Wilma Dolan, John Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, Pat Gillespie, Patrick Holland, John Kelly, Robert McClay Jnr, Mary McDaid, Anne McElhinney, Hughie McElhinney, George McGilloway, Teresa McGonagle, Anna Patton, Hannah Patton, Harry Patton, Margaret Tighe. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to recent collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,307.14 (23/8/26), £1,306.96 (9/8/26), £1,507.68 (2/8/26)

Clonleigh: €1,561.34 (23/8/26), €1,455.84 (9/8/26), €1,593.41 (2/8/26)

Camus: £1,508.47 (23/8/26), £1,727.60 (9/8/26), £1,731.47 (2/8/26)

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 6th September:

1st Reading: Ezekiel 33:7-9

Psalm: 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 13:8-10

Gospel: Matthew 18:15-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Donegal Down's Syndrome Assoc Annual Church Gate Collection this weekend at St Patrick's Murlog. Your support for this important fundraising event is greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down's syndrome and their families across Donegal.

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, 'Living Water', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. You are warmly invited to the streaming of **World Council of Churches online service** marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm at The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU. For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com RSVP: 07711900420.

A Prayer for our Earth (Pope Francis, Laudato Si, 246)

(Tuesday 1st September - World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation)

All-powerful God, you are present in the whole universe and in the smallest of your creatures. You embrace with your tenderness all that exists. Pour out upon us the power of your love, that we may protect life and beauty. Fill us with peace, that we may live as brothers and sisters, harming no one. O God of the poor, help us to rescue the abandoned and forgotten of this earth, so precious in your eyes.

Bring healing to our lives, that we may protect the world and not prey on it, that we may sow beauty, not pollution and destruction. Touch the hearts of those who look only for gain at the expense of the poor and the earth.

Teach us to discover the worth of each thing, to be filled with awe and contemplation, to recognise that we are profoundly united with every creature as we journey towards your infinite light. We thank you for being with us each day.

Encourage us, we pray, in our struggle for justice, love, and peace.

Come and See Have you heard about the Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren't sure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come and see' before you make your decision. Classes will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 - 9.00 pm beginning on 3rd September in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham. First half hour is prayer and worship. Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. Application deadline: October 1st. Tuition fees will then be applied. More information or register at <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sun 13th Sept at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. All welcome. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on 13th Sept at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year. All welcome.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on Tuesday 1st September starting with Rosary at 6.45 pm, celebration of Mass at 7.15 pm followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September at 12 noon in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny. Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 31; September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 - a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day: Sun 6 September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hours per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. For application pack, please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary will take place on Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm at Market Square, Letterkenny. Everyone welcome.

Blood Cancer Awareness Month Strabane Fundraising Branch will hold a sponsored walk on Friday 4th September at 7.00 pm starting from MK's Bar on the Derry Road. Suitable for all. Please join us.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention: **For the care of water.** Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Cancer Focus NI - Pink Colour Fun Run takes place at Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October. Details available at www.cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug - alternate Sundays - 13th Sept)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept - alternate Sundays – 20th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.

Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

29th & 30th August 2026
(22nd Sunday Ordinary Time)

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm
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We wish to express our deepest sympathy to the family and friends of James Houten, Benduff, his Funeral Mass took place on Wednesday & John McLaughlin, Glentogher, his Funeral Mass took place on Wednesday.

	<u>B</u>	<u>M</u>	
Sat 29 th Aug	Mary Browne, Hollymount	Month's Mind	7pm
Sun 30 th Aug	John Collins, Gortin (30 th Anniv)	9am	
Wed 2 nd Sep	Mary Doyle, Benduff	10am	
Mon 7 th Sep	Danny Doherty (Newman), Ballyloskey	9am	
Fri 11 th Sep	Kathleen Ruddy, Ballyloskey (1 st Anniv)	7pm	
Sat 12 th Sep	Jimmy Diver, Whitehouse (1 st Anniv)	7pm	
Sun 13 th Sep	Anne Doyle, Benduff	9am	
Mon 14 th Sep	Patricia McCallion, Magherarnett	10am	
Tue 15 th Sep	Liam Monagle, Ballyliffin	10am	
Fri 18 th Sep	im Reid, Drimdoo	Month's Mind	7pm
Sat 19 th Sep	Brian McLaughlin, Lenamore (1 st Anniv)	7pm	

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Terry Mallon; Bronagh McLaughlin, Glassalts & Eveline McLaughlin,
Australia & Carndonagh

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SUNDAY 30 AUGUST 2026

Twenty Second Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 31 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 1 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 2 Sept			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 3 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 4 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 5 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm: <i>First Anniversary, Isobel Coyle</i>	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 6 Sept	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 13 & 27 Sept</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Please note that Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament resumes this week in Aghyaran and Castlederg, on 3 and 4 September respectively, as above. Liturgy of the Word will resume the following week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £865 & €10. Church Restoration Fund: £809 & €77.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,220 & €136, made up of:

Castlederg £1,413 & €80, Drumnabey £453 & €36, Dregish £354. **DRUMQUIN:** £608.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: The August draw will take place after Mass in Dregish this Sunday. Good luck to everyone.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Gerry O'Kane, Dooish Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Thursday, and Danny O'Donnell, Meenamullin Road, Killeter, whose Funeral Mass took place in Aghyaran on Friday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are returning to school this week or are starting school for the first time. We continue to remember in prayer all who are preparing to commence third-level education at this time and those who are taking up employment for the first time. **May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You.**

- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER** lifted the Bible with the intention of reading it....but maybe just managed a few pages, before giving up in vain?
- ♦ **DID YOU KNOW** that the Bible is not actually a book? It is a Library - of 73 books.
- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER THOUGHT ABOUT** how the books of the Bible fit together – move along a timeline - to reveal God's plan for our salvation?
- ♦ **WOULD YOU LIKE TO GAIN** a deeper knowledge and understanding of the Bible so that, when reading or listening to the Scripture readings at Mass on Sunday, you will have a much clearer understanding of them and of how they apply to our everyday lives?

It is our aim over the next number of weeks to **take the 'mystery' out of the Bible** and to give us all a whole new understanding and love of God's Word. In **St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg**, we are going to run an eight-week Bible Study course called **"Unlocking the mysteries of the Bible."** It will take place over the course of **eight Wednesday evenings, commencing 9 September, from 7.30 – 9.00pm**. This course is presented by renowned Catholic speaker Jeff Cavins who, through engaging video presentations and his acclaimed **Bible Timeline** approach, will literally unlock the mystery of the Bible for us.

There will be opportunity for small-group discussion, with the aid of a workbook, with which you will be provided. There is a suggested donation of £15, which will include your workbook, a colour-coded Bible Timeline Card which will be a useful tool as we move along the 'timeline' of the course. Refreshments will be provided.

You can book for the course in advance via Fr Paul / the Parish Office or just come along and enrol on Wednesday 9 September. Let us unlock the mystery of the Bible together. Everyone is welcome.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 31 Aug: Dregish, commencing at 11.00am. **Thursday 3 Sept:** Corgary, Tullicar, Aghyaran, Killeter, Scraghey, Coolcreaghy, Shanog Road, Laghel Road, commencing after 10.00am Mass – Fr Paul. **Friday 4 Sept:** Garvagh, The Laghts, Lisnacloon, Magheranageeragh, Mullinabreen, Trienamongan, commencing 11.00am – Fr Paul.

LORETO GRAMMAR SCHOOL, OMAGH: Arrangements for School Opening: Years 9, 10 & 11 only – Tue 1 Sept; Years 8 & 12 only – Wed 2 Sept; Years 13 & 14 only – Thurs 3 Sept; All pupils – Fri 4 Sept.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie. Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY: Annual National Mass, Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions start back next Friday, 4 September, at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – this Friday, 4 September, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOYORCYCLES will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLi Station, to present the donation to the RNLi.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Second Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 30th August 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 16:21-27*)

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love. Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice. Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection.

True PROFIT is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is *Pursuing* God's purpose, *Rejecting* empty paths, *Offering* our lives, *Following* faithfully, *Investing* in what lasts, and *Treasuring* our souls. When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

*May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind,
so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.*

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 2nd September at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Feast of St Pio – Wednesday 23rd September To celebrate the feast of St Pio, a triduum of prayer will take place in the parishes of our pastoral area on days beforehand – more details next week. Mass to celebrate the feast day will take place on Wednesday 23rd September at 7 pm in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am – 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd.** Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am – 1.00 pm.** Everyone welcome.

We wish every blessing on all the students, teachers and school staff of our parish pastoral area, as they return to school. God bless for the year ahead.

Prayer for a New School Year We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave. During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year. We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. Amen.

Requiescat in Pace Martin Gallagher, Bingley, Yorkshire (formerly of Laurel Drive)

Anniversaries Margaret Connolly, Dympna Coyle, Edward Crawford, Wilma Dolan, John Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, Pat Gillespie, Patrick Holland, John Kelly, Robert McClay Jnr, Mary McDaid, Anne McElhinney, Hughie McElhinney, George McGilloway, Teresa McGonagle, Anna Patton, Hannah Patton, Harry Patton, Margaret Tighe. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to recent collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,307.14 (23/8/26), £1,306.96 (9/8/26), £1,507.68 (2/8/26)

Clonleigh: €1,561.34 (23/8/26), €1,455.84 (9/8/26), €1,593.41 (2/8/26)

Camus: £1,508.47 (23/8/26), £1,727.60 (9/8/26), £1,731.47 (2/8/26)

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 6th September:

1st Reading: Ezekiel 33:7-9

Psalm: 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 13:8-10

Gospel: Matthew 18:15-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Donegal Down's Syndrome Assoc Annual Church Gate Collection this weekend at St Patrick's Murlog. Your support for this important fundraising event is greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down's syndrome and their families across Donegal.

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September – 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, 'Living Water', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. You are warmly invited to the streaming of **World Council of Churches online service** marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm at The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU. For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com RSVP: 07711900420.

A Prayer for our Earth (Pope Francis, Laudato Si, 246)

(Tuesday 1st September – World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation)

All-powerful God, you are present in the whole universe and in the smallest of your creatures. You embrace with your tenderness all that exists. Pour out upon us the power of your love, that we may protect life and beauty. Fill us with peace, that we may live as brothers and sisters, harming no one. O God of the poor, help us to rescue the abandoned and forgotten of this earth, so precious in your eyes. Bring healing to our lives, that we may protect the world and not prey on it, that we may sow beauty, not pollution and destruction. Touch the hearts of those who look only for gain at the expense of the poor and the earth. Teach us to discover the worth of each thing, to be filled with awe and contemplation, to recognise that we are profoundly united with every creature as we journey towards your infinite light. We thank you for being with us each day. Encourage us, we pray, in our struggle for justice, love, and peace.

Come and See Have you heard about the Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren't sure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come and see' before you make your decision. Classes will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 – 9.00 pm beginning on 3rd September in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham. First half hour is prayer and worship. Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. Application deadline: October 1st. Tuition fees will then be applied. More information or register at <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sun 13th Sept at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. All welcome. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on 13th Sept at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year. All welcome.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on Tuesday 1st September starting with Rosary at 6.45 pm, celebration of Mass at 7.15 pm followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September at 12 noon in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny. Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 31; September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 – a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am – 12.30 pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day: Sun 6 September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hours per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. For application pack, please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary will take place on Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm at Market Square, Letterkenny. Everyone welcome.

Blood Cancer Awareness Month Strabane Fundraising Branch will hold a sponsored walk on Friday 4th September at 7.00 pm starting from MK's Bar on the Derry Road. Suitable for all. Please join us.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention: **For the care of water.** Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run takes place at Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October. Details available at www.cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug – alternate Sundays – 13th Sept)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept – alternate Sundays – 20th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes. **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



clonmanyparish.ie



Clonmany Parish Newsletter



Fr John McDevitt PP Tel 0749376273 or 085 8237119

Fr Karl Haan CC Tel 0749379107

Parish Office Tel 0749376114 Email: clonmanyparish1@outlook.com

COLLECTIONS

Parish collection last weekend amounted to 2,933. Thank you for your generosity to the collection on Cemetery Sunday which amounted to €3,3197 and £198 and goes to the upkeep of the three cemeteries. Last year we spent €6,300 on tree cutting and this work was also supported by parishioner donations. In the past few years €14,000 was also spent on the new cemetery. Thank you for your ongoing support.

SEASON OF CREATION 2026 PRAYER

Living Water—Holy God, whose Spirit hovered over the waters at the beginning, we gather as part of your community of all creation, thirsty for your grace. We give thanks for the gift of water, the veins of our common home, that sustains the cedar and the whale, the pasture and the city. We are grateful for the local waters that nourish our homelands and our fellow creatures. We give thanks that in your well-watered garden, every drop is a sacred testament to your love.

Yet, we confess that we have treated this gift as a mere commodity. We have choked the seas with our waste and watched the warming tides rise in judgment. We lament the cracked earth of the drought-stricken and the salty tears of the climate refugee. Melt our frozen hearts, O God, and let the waters of repentance flow.

Lord of all Life, you promised that wherever the river flows, everything shall live. Stir in us a calling to care for the waters — to protect the watershed, defend the rights of water, and honour the dignity of the thirsty. May your Word be a spring within us, gushing forth for the healing of the nations.

May God our Father who brought water from the rock sustain us in the desert. May Christ our Lord who is Living Water refresh us for the work of restoration. And may the Holy Spirit carry us on currents of grace until justice rolls down like waters and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream. Amen.



VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

PARISH MASS AND PRAYER SCHEDULE

ST MARY'S CHURCH, CLONMANY

- Monday—Thursday 9:30am Mass
- Friday 7:30pm—Confessions from 7pm
- Saturday 6:30pm V Mass—Confessions from 6pm
- Sunday 11:30am
- Wednesday: *Exposition of The Blessed Sacrament 2:30pm—3:30pm in the room behind the Sanctuary*

ST MICHAEL'S CHURCH, URRIS

- Sunday: 10am Mass
- Friday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 3-6pm*

ORATORY OF THE ASSUMPTION, BALLYLIFFIN

- Tuesday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 7:30—8:30pm*

MASS INTENTION THIS WEEKEND

6:30pm Vigil Mass—Denis McLaughlin, The Castles.

MONTH'S MIND MASSES

7:30pm Mass in St Mary's Church on Fri Sept 4 will be offered for John Doherty, Cregmagor, on his month's mind
10am Mass in St Michael's Church on Sunday Sept 6 will be offered for Sarah McGonigle, Rostown on her month's mind. May they rest in peace.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

6:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary's Church next Saturday Sept 5 will be offered for Marion Fagan-Grant, Ballyliffin & Dublin on her first anniversary. May she rest in peace.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Monday: St Aidan of Lindisfarne, Bishop & Missionary
Tuesday: World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation
Thursday: St Gregory the Great, Pope & Doctor of the Church
Friday: St Mac Nissi, Bishop—First Friday
Saturday: St Teresa of Calcutta (Mother Teresa)

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through holy baptism
Mairéad Helena Barkley, Cleagh; Ronan William Doherty, Carndonagh and Kyra Brie Gill, Gaddyduff.

SYMPATHY

We offer sincere sympathy to the family and friends of Anthony McDaid, Magheramore, who died during the week. May he rest in peace.

LEGION OF MARY

Bus trip to Knock of Sunday Sept 27— Contact James on 086 1256357.

ROSARY

The Rosary continues on Wednesday at 8:30pm at the Grotto in St Mary's Church, Clonmany—All welcome as we pray for peace.



READERS, LAY MINISTERS & COLLECTORS FOR SEPTEMBER

Readers: Vigil Mass - Catherine Gill, 10am Liam Doherty, 11:30am - Yvonne McCarron

Lay Ministers: Vigil Mass - Breege Gill, Mary Friel & M. McGeoghegan
10am Mass – Kathleen Doherty & John Diver
11:30am Mass – Roisin Devlin, Patsy Grant & Johnny McEleney

Collectors: Vigil Mass: Laurence Harkin & Paul Doherty
10am - Hubert Diver, Rostown.
11:30am - Pat Doherty & Johnny McEleney

SVP Collectors: Vigil Mass - Corney Doherty James Doherty.
10am Mass - Liam Doherty & Yvonne Walsh
11:30am - Joe Coyle & Mary McLaughlin

CHURCH GATE COLLECTION

Annual collection for Down Syndrome will be taken up after all masses this weekend August 29 & 30.

MENS ROSARY

The Rosary will be recited in the Square, Malin Town on Saturday September 5 at 1pm.

PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP

The Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty will take place on Tues Sept 1 starting with Rosary at 6.45pm. Mass at 7.15pm followed with blessing with a first class relic of St. Pio.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND

Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday Sept 6 at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2pm celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents—a lovely day for the whole family—info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome.

CLONMANY SHAMROCKS NEWS

Lotto Numbers: 20/08/2026—10,13,14,27. No jackpot winner—€20
Prizes: Thomas Comiskey, Buncrana; Frances Maher; Urris ; Celine McConalogue, Online. Next draw on 27/08/2026. Jackpot €15,000.
Fixtures: Sunday 30th Clubman Shirts League Cup:
Greencastle FC v Clonmany Shamrocks at 2pm
Inishowen Eng. Div 2: Carrowmena v Clonmany Res at 11am
August 200 Club Draw will take place on Monday 31st August.
Can all promoters make their returns before this date—thank you.

CLONMANY TUG-O-WAR GROUP

Will hold their AGM on Friday September 18 in Clonmany Tug-of-war clubhouse at 8pm. All welcome.

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE NOTES

Yoga class Mon Sept 7th at 7pm—to book contact Marie 0872962646
Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back on Wed Sept 9.
Free Smartphone & Tablet course starting Tues Sept 22 from 10:30-12:30—to book contact the centre on 0749361742.

Prayer for A New School Year

God of wisdom and might,
we praise you for
the wonder of our being,
for mind, body and spirit.
Be with our children
as they begin a new school year.
Bless them and their teachers
and staff. Give them strength and
grace as their bodies grow;
wisdom and knowledge to their minds
as they search for understanding;
and peace and zeal to their hearts.
We ask this through
Jesus Christ our Lord.

Amen.

CatholicCompany.com *Because Faith Matters*

A Prayer for Teachers

Lord God,
your spirit of wisdom fills the earth
and teaches us in your ways. Look upon
these teachers. Let them strive to share their
knowledge with gentle patience and endeavor
always to bring the truth to eager minds. Grant
that we may follow Jesus Christ, the way,
the truth and the life, forever and ever.

Amen.

CatholicCompany.com *Because Faith Matters*

Culdaff
Fr. John McDewitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119

Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107

www.culdaffparish.com

email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass

Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am
[Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm]; **no Mass on Thursday; Friday** First Friday of the Month, 7.30 pm; **No Mass on Saturday morning.**

Saturday Vigil 8 pm
Sunday 10 am.

Anniversary Mass next weekend

Saturday, 8 pm : Mary Mc Conalogue, Cashel
Sunday, 10 am James Doherty, The Cottages, Gleneely

Weekly Offering €680

Development Collection €265.

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading

Jeremiah 20:7-9

Jeremiah laments but cannot fail to speak in God's name.

Second Reading

Romans 12:1-2

Paul encourages the Romans to stay faithful to God.

Gospel Reading

Matthew 16:21-27

Jesus speaks of his Passion and rebukes Peter for his objection.

VOCATIONS That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6**

September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Group 1 of the Altar Society begin this weekend

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054)

-Baby Reflexology with Chantel starting Tuesday 1st September 0863137817 to register your interest.
- The Mindful Maker crafting and upcycling course, 6 weeks starting Monday 14th September 7-9pm €30.
- Sewing Club starting back Wednesday 9th September 7-9pm Tel: 00447752682086 to book.

Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061

The **Sunday Night Dance** will take place this Sunday, 30th August, 8pm. Old time, ceilidh, line dancing and jiving. Admission €5 including supper.

We have lots of great courses coming up for the autumn including Spanish conversation and culture, beauty therapy, plumbing and heating, phone photography, dressmaking and alterations, creative painting, guitar lessons, tablet and smartphone for beginners, creative crafts, digital skills for farmers and internet skills level 3. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

The Padre Pio Prayer Group,

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty will take place on **Tuesday 1 September 2026**. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before mass, celebration of holy mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. EVERYONE WELCOME.

A Feast of Folk with

Patsy Cavanagh and friends every Tuesday evening at 8pm during July and August in The Cairn Greencastle. Enquiries tel 074 9381104

Anam Cara Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold it's monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on **Thursday 10th September 2026 at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15.**

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age of their child, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. There is no need for registration, this is a walk in meeting. We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

The Deep End: Not Again Peter!

by Jane Mellett

Poor Peter. He never seems to get it quite right. His journey throughout the Gospel is definitely one of ups and downs as one minute he is a ROCK, the next a failure. Peter wants the journey of discipleship to be a happy, rosy place where all is well because God is in his life. Unfortunately it is not that simple as having our minds set on 'divine things' means that we must be agents of change in this world where 'human things' are concerned. Peter is being moulded into the rock that he needs to be although at times he appears as a small stone.

To be an agent of change usually means being counter-cultural and that brings many challenges and 'crosses'. That is Jesus' message to his followers – if you are interested in my Kingdom, then that will involve hardship along the way. Why? Because the Kingdom that Jesus proclaims is one where everyone is included, where justice and peace reign and communities are built on the principles of solidarity, mutuality, respect and love. And not just any love, but AGAPE love, i.e. love of people we may not even like. Why is this so hard? Jesus' love changes things. It is a radical love, one with no boundaries, to achieve a world where this Kingdom is a reality will most definitely involve going against the grain and therein lie the crosses. Jesus is trying to explain to Peter the path that lies ahead.

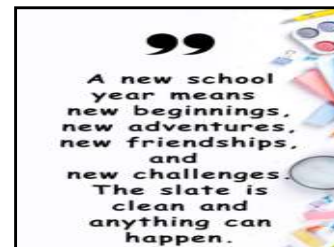
Car boot sale on Saturday 5th Sept in Malin G.A.A training pitch. Commencing from 9am to 1pm. €10 per car boot. Money going toward Marinwood, The Field Group. A great way to support the club, either by buying or selling something. Sure to be a great event. Hope to see you all there.

Charity walk. From Carn to Malin on Sunday 13th September at 12pm. Meeting in the diamond in Carn at 11:45 am.
Adults : €10, Kids : €5, Family : €20
All proceeds in aid of Malinwood, The Field Group.
Get your walking shoes on and join in the fun !!!

The Men's Shed Carn is running a Furniture Restoration and Upholstery course starting on Monday, September 14. From 7 pm to 9 pm, for 6 weeks. It's a great chance to learn new skills and finally restore that piece of furniture you have been meaning to for ages !
To book, email mens.shed.carn@gmail.com or call 087 4611571.
The Men's Shed Carn is also hosting **"DROP IN WEDNESDAYS"** for men every Wednesday from 11 am -1 pm. Pop in for a coffee and a chat and see what we do here at the shed, a place to connect, learn and create. Bring a friend, meet new people. All ages welcome

<http://www.culdaffparish.com>
As the children and young

people prepare to return to school, we wish them well. We also spare a thought for their parents and teachers to whom we entrust their welfare. May God bless them all and keep them safe during this school year.



POINTS TO PONDER - Peter has just been congratulated as the rock on which Jesus will build his church. He is comfortable in a theology of grace and glory. Suddenly that rock looks sandy and unsafe. Jesus calls him abruptly out of his comfort zone into the real world where suffering must be faced (cross is used here as a proverbial term for suffering and agony, not referring specifically to Jesus' crucifixion). One of the ideas in the gospel is that we take up the cross of doing what is right and being willing to bear it. Like parents who try to explain, cajole, encourage and define what is right for their children, even when they are thought foolish. Jesus bore a cross to the end of his convictions and love. Taking the cross is also accepting and living with pain, suffering of any sort, and the griefs of life we can do nothing about. Crosses may be inflicted on us by others. We know of people who have accepted a heavy burden in life and who ploughed tough furrows, through no fault of their own. They have been helped often by the example of the one who carried the cross to the end. Help often came to them also from family, friends and neighbours. On the way to Calvary, Jesus was helped by one man, remembered forever, Simon from Africa. Help can come from expected or unexpected quarters, but help there must be if we are to bear our crosses in life. In prayer we might ask how we help those near us carry the burdens of their lives.

CULMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

SUNDAY, 30TH AUGUST 2026

22ND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Faith • Prayer • Community

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 16:21–27

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of **surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love**.

Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice.

Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection

True **PROFIT** is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is:

P — Pursuing God's purpose

R — Rejecting empty paths

O — Offering our lives

F — Following faithfully

I — Investing in what lasts

T — Treasuring our souls

When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind, so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.

Prayer for a New School Year

We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave.

During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. **Amen.**

Saints of the Coming Week

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Season of Creation

1st September – 4th October

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This year's theme, '**Living Water**', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

You are warmly invited to the streaming of World Council of Churches online service marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on **Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm** at **The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU.**

For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com

RSVP: 07711900420.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.

All welcome.

Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN** for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

All welcome.



Padre Pio Prayer Group

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on **Tuesday 1st September**, starting with Rosary at **6.45 pm**, celebration of Mass at **7.15 pm** followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Visit: derryvocations.org



Donegal Group 173 – Rise and Shine Trust

Celebrating 40 Years

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating **40 years** of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter.

We are celebrating with a special Mass on **Saturday 26th September at 12 noon** in the **Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny**.

Mass will be concelebrated by **Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown** and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years.

We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: loughderg.org

All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino

A Day of Pilgrimage, Prayer, Brotherhood and Renewal

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner)

Visit: dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

Join us on **Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm** at **Murphy's on the Green**.

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity – Sacristan

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour

For application pack, please contact:

Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Telephone: 028 71262302

Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary

The September Men's Rosary will take place on **Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm** at **Market Square, Letterkenny**.

Everyone welcome.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September

For the Care of Water

You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention:

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run

The **Pink Colour Fun Run** takes place at **Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October**.

Details available at **cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run**

† Faith • Hope • Community

Please remember in your prayers all those who are sick, bereaved, lonely or in need, and all those who have asked for our prayers.

**Parish of Dunboe, Macosquin and
Aghadowey**

Sunday 30th August 2026
Year A Psalter Week II



Rev Neil Farren PP. Chapelfield, 59 Laurel Hill
Road, Coleraine BT51 3PY Tele: 028 7034 3130
Parish Secretary: Clare White at Chapelfield
Office hours This week:
Tuesday 1st September – 09.30– 1.30pm
Friday 4th September – 09.30 – 1.30pm

Parish Email: cpdma@btinternet.com
Parish Website: www.dmaparish.com

SVP Helpline: Tel: 07752017340
Safeguarding Officer: Mrs Bernadette Eastwood

Emergency Calls: Father Neil Farren - 07710860966

Age Concern Tele 02870357966
Good morning, Causeway For elderly and vulnerable
people. Tele 02870558005
Lifeline Crisis Response Helpline 0808 808 8000
North Coast Community Transport Tele 02870321234
Samaritans Tele 116123
St Vincent de Paul Tele 07752017340
Wave Trauma Centre for Mental Health and Wellbeing
Tele 0282766990 **Women's Aid** Tele 02870356
**Onus – Men & Women affected by domestic or
sexual abuse in NI – 0808 802 1414 (Freephone 24hr)**

Recently Deceased

David (Mansy) McDaid

Months Mind

Liam Moran (Mass 11am Mass St John's Sunday)

Anniversaries

Adrienne Lafferty (3rd anniversary Mass Saturday
Vigil St John's), Mary Lynn, Charlie Booth, Annie
Conway, Sean McAfee, Patricia McNally, George
Crawford, William McLaughlin

Pastoral Council Meeting

Thurs day 3rd September 7.30pm – Chapelfield

Liturgy Committee Meeting

Monday 7th September – 10.30am – St Johns Sacristy

Parish Collections 22nd & 23rd August 2026

St Johns Aghadowey Dunboe
Weekly: £656.19 £307.00 £180.00
Loose: £294.31 £126.52 £18.00
Total: £1582.02

Masses - week commencing 31st August

Church	St Johns	Dunboe	Aghadowey
Monday	10am		
Tuesday	10am	12pm	
Wednesday	7pm		
Thursday	10am		12pm
Friday	10am		
Saturday	6pm	7.30pm	
Sunday	11am		9.45am

Dunboe Reader/ Offertory Rota

Saturday 29th August – Catherine / Offertory – Seamus
& Linda
Saturday 5th September – Philomena / Offertory –
Alice & Michael
Saturday 12th September – Marie / Offertory – Martin
& Martina

Dunboe Eucharistic Minister Rota

Saturday 29th August – Maggie
Saturday 5th September – Vincent
Saturday 12th September – Linda
Saturday 19th September - Karen
Dunboe Cleaning & Flowers Rota
September– Philomena McAlister

St Johns Eucharistic Minister

Saturday 5th September – Felicity Ferris
Sunday 6th September – Peter Devlin

St Johns Minister of the Word September

Vigil: Diana
Sunday Mass: Sean

Aghadowey Offertory

Sunday 30th August – Paddy & Violet Dempsey
Sunday 6th September – Don & Mary McNicholl
Sundav 13th September – Sean & Martin Kellv

**Eucharistic Adoration will recommence every
Wednesday from 6pm – 7pm before evening
Mass**

BABY MASSAGE & REFLEXOLOGY CLASSES

6-week course starting 9th September in **Ballerin**.

For more information or to book: diane@groundedsoles.org |
07761 054666

**FUNDRAISING
CONCERT**

**MICHAEL
ENGLISH
& BAND**

Book online with Eventbrite
(<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/>)
Search for:
Michael English, Keenaught.

**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH
KEENAUGHT**

FRIDAY 2ND OCTOBER 2026

8PM
DOORS OPEN 7:15PM
TICKETS £30

Tickets available from: Heron's Gift Shop, Draperstown;
Moneyneena Post Office; Desertmartin Parish Office and
Ballinascreen Parish Office.

We Pray

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage
and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by
renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and
finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

A BACK-TO-SCHOOL PRAYER

Loving God, thank you for the rest and
relaxation we enjoyed over the summer.
Today, we pray for our children as
they begin their new school year.
Bless them with joy at seeing
friends, excitement at new
experiences, and a love of learning.
Watch over all who learn, replacing
fear with joy, anxiety with peace,
and tiredness with energy.
Grant teachers wisdom, patience,
and joy in serving their students.
In Jesus' name we pray.
Amen.



Wishing Stephen Doherty (Articlave) a very happy 90th
Birthday for Tuesday 1st September. Many
Congratulations!



Parish Trip

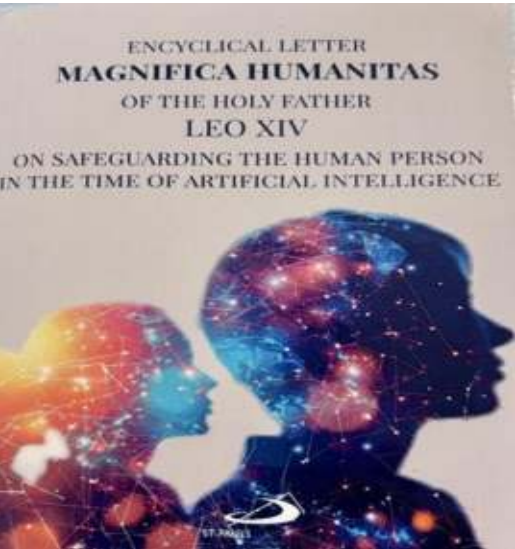
A special thanks to Father Farren for facilitating our
Parish Day trip to Glenveagh National Park & Ards
Friary. After a brief showery spell, the weather cleared
up for a great day out which was much enjoyed by all.



Encyclical Letter

**Magnifica Humanitas – On safeguarding the
Human Person in the time of Artificial
intelligence.**

Copies of Pope Leo XIV's book are still available to
purchase in the sacristy at a cost of £8 per copy.



SUNDAY 30 AUGUST 2026

Twenty Second Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran • Ardstraw West & Castlederg • Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O’Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 31 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 1 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 2 Sept			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 3 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 4 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 5 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm: <i>First Anniversary, Isobel Coyle</i>	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 6 Sept	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 13 & 27 Sept</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Please note that Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament resumes this week in Aghyaran and Castlederg, on 3 and 4 September respectively, as above. Liturgy of the Word will resume the following week.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week’s collection:

AGHYARAN: £865 & €10. Church Restoration Fund: £809 & €77.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,220 & €136, made up of:

Castlederg £1,413 & €80, Drumnabey £453 & €36, Dregish £354. **DRUMQUIN:** £608.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG PARISH DRAW: The August draw will take place after Mass in Dregish this Sunday. Good luck to everyone.

†

We pray for the happy repose of the souls of Gerry O’Kane, Dooish Road, whose Funeral Mass took place in Drumquin on Thursday, and Danny O’Donnell, Meenamullin Road, Killeter, whose Funeral Mass took place in Aghyaran on Friday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to their families and to all who mourn their deaths. May they rest in peace.

Please remember in prayer our young parishioners, family members and friends who are returning to school this week or are starting school for the first time. We continue to remember in prayer all who are preparing to commence third-level education at this time and those who are taking up employment for the first time. **May Your love be upon them, O Lord, as they place all their trust in You.**

- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER** lifted the Bible with the intention of reading it....but maybe just managed a few pages, before giving up in vain?
- ♦ **DID YOU KNOW** that the Bible is not actually a book? It is a Library - of 73 books.
- ♦ **HAVE YOU EVER THOUGHT ABOUT** how the books of the Bible fit together – move along a timeline - to reveal God's plan for our salvation?
- ♦ **WOULD YOU LIKE TO GAIN** a deeper knowledge and understanding of the Bible so that, when reading or listening to the Scripture readings at Mass on Sunday, you will have a much clearer understanding of them and of how they apply to our everyday lives?

It is our aim over the next number of weeks to **take the 'mystery' out of the Bible** and to give us all a whole new understanding and love of God's Word. In **St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg**, we are going to run an eight-week Bible Study course called **"Unlocking the mysteries of the Bible."** It will take place over the course of **eight Wednesday evenings, commencing 9 September, from 7.30 – 9.00pm**. This course is presented by renowned Catholic speaker Jeff Cavins who, through engaging video presentations and his acclaimed **Bible Timeline** approach, will literally unlock the mystery of the Bible for us.

There will be opportunity for small-group discussion, with the aid of a workbook, with which you will be provided. There is a suggested donation of £15, which will include your workbook, a colour-coded Bible Timeline Card which will be a useful tool as we move along the 'timeline' of the course. Refreshments will be provided.

You can book for the course in advance via Fr Paul / the Parish Office or just come along and enrol on Wednesday 9 September. Let us unlock the mystery of the Bible together. Everyone is welcome.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 31 Aug: Dregish, commencing at 11.00am. **Thursday 3 Sept:** Corgary, Tullicar, Aghyaran, Killeter, Scraghey, Coolcreaghy, Shanog Road, Laghel Road, commencing after 10.00am Mass – Fr Paul. **Friday 4 Sept:** Garvagh, The Laghts, Lisnacloon, Magheranageeragh, Mullinabreen, Trienamongan, commencing 11.00am – Fr Paul.

LORETO GRAMMAR SCHOOL, OMAGH: Arrangements for School Opening: Years 9, 10 & 11 only – Tue 1 Sept; Years 8 & 12 only – Wed 2 Sept; Years 13 & 14 only – Thurs 3 Sept; All pupils – Fri 4 Sept.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie. Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY: Annual National Mass, Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details, email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions start back next Friday, 4 September, at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome!

TEAM HOPE FUNDRAISING GARDEN PARTY – this Friday, 4 September, 2.00 – 7.00pm, 30 Lurganbuoy Road, Castlederg. Live music with Macdara O'Dwyer. Tea, coffee, treats, raffle, garden games, fun for children and families. Deborah Lowry wishes you to know that everyone is welcome - drop in at any time during the afternoon or evening.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOYORCYCLES will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLi Station, to present the donation to the RNLi.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

**Twenty-Second Sunday
in Ordinary Time**

30th August 2026



Parish of Drumragh

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh

St Mary's Church, Drumragh

028 82242092

Weekend Mass Schedule

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh

Vigil: 5.30pm

Sunday Mass: 10am & 12.30pm

St. Mary's Church, Drumragh

Sunday Mass: 10.30am

Confessions:

Sacred Heart Church: Saturday's after morning Mass unless there is a funeral.

Christ the King, Strathroy:

Saturday 6.15pm-6.45pm

Weekday Mass Times this week

10.00am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday in St. Mary's, Killyclogher

10.00am Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat.

in Sacred Heart Church

7.30pm Wednesday Sacred Heart

Rosary before 7.30pm Mass

Eucharistic Adoration on
Wednesday from 10am until
6.45pm

PARISH ACCOUNTS

The Administrator and Committees of the Parish of Drumragh would like to thank the Parishioners for their support this year especially in the light of the great loss to the Parish of Father Eugene Hassan PP, our Parish Priest.

The maintenance and upkeep of the Sacred Heart Church has been and remains a very significant financial commitment. The Parish has been proactive in seeking grant support and has secured lottery funding for the significant external and internal works. These works which are due to commence in early 2027 are expected to cost in the region of £1,644,000.00 and the Parish will be obliged to contribute 23% of the value.

In real terms the Parish will have an outlay of £380,000 payable at appointed stages of construction. These works represent a significant and recurring financial commitment and we are privileged to be able to facilitate these works thanks to the generosity of Drumragh Parish Parishioners.

We will have to rely on that generosity into the future, and we trust, without reservation, and with gratitude, that your weekly envelope will continue to be a priority.

A summary of the accounts are on page 4

Loreto Grammar School, Omagh - Arrangements for School Opening September 2026

Year 9,10,11 only	Tuesday 1 st September 2026
Year 8,12 only	Wednesday 2 nd September 2026
Year 13,14 only	Thursday 3 rd September 2026
School Open: All pupils	Friday 4th September 2026

Parish Office Open Mon/Tues/Thursday 9-2pm 02882242092

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Sacred Heart Church Mass Intentions

Wednesday 2nd September 7.30pm	Francis Darlington Month Mind
Saturday 5th September 5.30pm	Gerard Drumm - 2nd Anniversary
Sunday 6th September 12.30pm	Pat Turbett - 2nd Anniversary

ST. MARY'S, DRUMRAGH Mass Intentions

Sunday 6th September 10.30am	Rose O'Neill - 10th Anniversary
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Sacrament of Baptism

We welcome new members of our Parish Community who received the

Sacrament of Baptism:
Hannah Grace O'Sullivan
Caiden Lee McCausland
Darri Ronan O'Neill
Eire Rois Barbour
Eirinn Eileen O'Kane



VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Prayer Group - Commencing Thursday 3rd September

A quiet time of prayer and reflection
Christ the King Church

Strathroy 7pm Thurs 3rd September

Join us for an hour of prayer for the Souls in Purgatory and Our Own Intentions. First Thursday of every month in Christ the King Church, Strathroy at 7pm.

Recent Weddings

We congratulate the following couple who were married here recently

Louise O'Neill & Brendan Mullan

May the grace of the sacrament remain with them all their lives.

Recently Deceased

Paul McCanny
Aiden McGrath
Josephine Murphy
May they rest in peace

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September to 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

The Padre Pio Prayer Group,

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty will take place on **Tuesday 1st September 2026**. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass, celebration of Holy Mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited.
EVERYONE WELCOME.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13th September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing.

Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

BINGO in St. Joseph's Hall Tuesday 1st September at 8.30pm

Parish Draw

The September draw takes place this week. Promoters are asked to please make their returns before **7.30pm on Tuesday 1st September**. Please note, the deadline of 7.30pm is strict and late returns may not be accepted.

Important Notice for Wedding Parties Confetti must **not** be used inside the church or in the surrounding grounds. Unfortunately, confetti was recently scattered on the altar and in the church aisles, creating a considerable mess.

Please remember that our cleaners are **volunteers**, generously giving their time to care for the church. We ask for your cooperation in keeping the church respectful and welcoming for everyone.

Killyclogher Over 50's Club

Re-Opens on Thursday 3rd September / 2pm / Killyclogher Hall

Fun, Friendship & Food! If you enjoy company in a comfortable setting, you are welcome to join the Over 50's Club. Club activities include Bingo, Knitting, Crocheting, Armchair Exercises, Monthly Tea Dances; with occasional outings and enjoyable hot meals.

Come along and see for yourself - you will be very welcome!

The Club welcomes people, over 50, from neighbouring parishes. The more – the merrier

Alzheimer's society is running a Carers Information Support

Programme (CRISP) for family, carers and friends of people living with Dementia in Omagh area. The programme is run over 2 sessions; attendees should attend both afternoons. Dates are 7th and 8th September 2026 3-5pm In the Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh, Co Tyrone. To register please contact Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser. M:07889 604702. Registration is required prior

SONGS FROM HOME

Come together with **Harmonise** and fellow local singers as we share Songs from Home. Participants must attend **FREE** five week choir practice followed by the Final Song Trail 10th October at Ulster American Folk Park. Refreshments provided.

EVERYONE WELCOME - Contact Claire Sharkey for more details 07751371800

Dates

August 30th	1pm-4pm – Dromore Sports Complex
September 23rd	7.30-10pm – Silverbirch Hotel
September 30th	7.30-10pm – Dromore Sports Complex
October 7th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel

Loreto 170 Hyrox

Loreto Grammar School, Omagh, will host a special Loreto 170 Hyrox on Sunday 6th September, celebrating 170 years of Loreto Education, while raising funds for Dementia NI and the new Loreto Oratory. This inclusive, fully scaled and non-timed Hyrox event will take place on school grounds and warmly welcomes current and past pupils and staff, families, friends, and the wider community to come together, reconnect, and enjoy a day centred on participation and togetherness. Anyone wishing to take part can register using the sign-up link on the Schools Facebook or Instagram. Anyone who may not be able to participate is very welcome to drop in, show support, and donate towards these two meaningful causes.

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

St Joseph's Hall

Mon 4.30 pm - Groogan O' Doherty School of Dancing

Monday 7:05pm - St Joseph's Ceili Club for retired Irish dancers.

Tues 2.30 - 4.30pm - Colmcille Club **RESUMES ON 8TH SEPTEMBER**

Tues 8.30pm - Bingo

Wed 5.45 pm - Baxter School of Dancing

Thurs 8 pm - Bowls

Sat 2 pm - Groogan O'Doherty School of Dancing

***Booking forms and hall rates are available to
download at [www.drumraghparish.com/st.joseph's hall](http://www.drumraghparish.com/st.joseph's%20hall)***

West Tyrone Feis / AGM / St. Joseph's Hall, Omagh (Upstairs) Tues 8th Sept 7pm

Welcome new volunteers to join the committee and help support the running of the Feis.

If you would be interested in any section of the Feis, please come along to the A.G.M.

We would particularly welcome those with an interest in the Irish Dancing Section, as the previous secretary for this section has retired.

Drumragh Parish

Summary of Accounts 31.12.25

2025

2024

£

£

Recurrent income

Envelope Collections

224,722

229,579

Gift Aid

46,916

49,219

Other income

112,603

122,446

Total Recurrent income

384,241

401,244

Other non recurrent parish income

331,724

261,321

Total income

715,965

662,565

Recurrent Expenditure

Priests Salaries

22,306

28,871

Employee Salaries

106,918

93,576

Church & Pastoral Care

16,323

16,300

Premises Costs

174,584

224,818

Operating Costs

60,878

61,734

Diocesan Levy

52,162

48,653

Exceptional parish expenditure

7,871

108,152

Total expenditure

441,042

582,104

Final Surplus for the Year

274,923

80,461

30th August 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1858

Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.

Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. Email address

dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org

Parish Website <https://www.parishofdungiven.com>**SUNDAY MASS TIMES****Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey****Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven****Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven****Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn****Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven****WEEKDAY MASS TIMES****St. Patrick's:** Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS**For Corey Wason today Sunday 30th August at 11.30 am. in St. Patrick's.**MONTH'S MIND MASS**For Patrick McNicholl, Boviel Rd., on Thurs. 3rd Sept. at 7.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.**CONFESSIONS:** Will take place in St. Patrick's at 11.00 am. on Saturday.**THE ROSARY:** Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.**LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £3,161.***Thank you to all who contributed.***BAPTISM** – We welcome into our Christian Community: Aibreann Philomena O'Hagan, The Arches.**BAPTISM - Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.****CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP**

Meeting Thursday at 7.30 pm. in the Emmaus Hall.

VOCATIONS SOCIETY OF ST. JOSEPHOur next meeting will take place on Tues. 1st Sept. in the committee room, after 10.00 am. Mass.**Baptisms** will take place in St. Patrick's Church at 3.00 pm. *Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.***The Baptism Course:** Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course: Wednesday 9th September at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.****WEDDING BELLS** - We congratulate Rachel Farrell and Cathir Maguire on the occasion of their marriage on the 21st August 2026.We congratulate Stiofan Tracey and Bronagh O'Kane on the occasion of their marriage on the 22nd August 2026.**FR. SWEENEY – WILL VISIT THE SICK ON FRIDAY 4th SEPTEMBER***Drumsurn & Gortnaghey***THURSDAY 10th SEPTEMBER: Town area.****OUR MISSION AS CHURCH**Next weekend 5th & 6th September we will have the honour to welcome to our parish Sr. Orla Treacy and Sr. Noelle Corscadden from the Loreto Sisters Provincial South Sudan.

Sr. Orla and Sr. Noelle will be preaching at all Masses that weekend, sharing their experience of mission work, especially in the field of education for girls and young women. Our parish, through our Mission fund will be supporting them and their School for the next five years. At the 11.30 am. Mass on Sunday morning we will present them with a cheque as part of our effort from Dungiven to help them in this vital work. After the 11.30 am. Mass all are welcome to the Emmaus Hall (parish hall) to meet them both and have a cuppa.

BLESSING OF BIKERS & MOTORCYCLESWill take place on Sunday 13th September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal, at 1.30 pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point R.N.L.I station, to present the donation to the R.N.L.I. Please note! Mass will be celebrated on Sun. 13th Sept. in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11.30 am. for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.**MINISTERS OF HOLY COMMUNION FOR SEPTEMBER****ST. PATRICK'S:****Saturday 6.00 pm.**

James Kerlin & Mary O'Kane

Sunday 9.00 am.

Mary C. Murphy & Margaret McCloskey.

Sunday 11.30 am.

Mary McCloskey & Mary McKnight

READERS FOR AUGUST - ST. PATRICK'S:

Saturday 6.00 pm. – David Gallagher.

Sunday 9.00 am. – Leona McNicholl.

Sunday 11.30 am. – Liam McElhinney.

VOCATIONS: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.**ST. PADRE PIO HEALING MASS****Dates for your Diary:** Thurs. 24th Sept., Thurs. 22nd Oct., Thurs. 19th Nov. and Thurs. 17th Dec.**KEVIN LYNCH H. C. -** Lotto no's: 10, 13, 16 & 20. Lucky dip: Ashleen Hutchinson. Jackpot: £2,150. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Waness World.***WHIST DRIVE:**St. Peter's Hall, Drumsurn today, Sun. 30th Aug., at 7.30 pm.**LEGION OF MARY ROSARY**The Legion of Mary warmly invites you to join them for the Rosary on **Mon. 7th Sept. at 7.00 pm.** in Emmaus Hall. This Rosary will be offered for all pupils starting a new school year or returning to school or college, and for all teachers, classroom assistants, principals and staff. Tea, coffee, and light refreshments will be served afterwards. Everyone welcome.**LEGION OF MARY**The Legion of Mary hopes to organise a Day Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on **Sun. 27th Sept.**, subject to sufficient interest.If you would like to travel, please register your interest by texting **Mary McKnight** on **07548 887 853**, or by leaving your name with the Parish Office. The approximate bus fare will be **£25 p. p.****BEREAVED BY SUICIDE – SUPPORT MEETING**If you have been affected by the loss of a loved one to suicide, you are not alone and support is available. The next meeting will take place on Mon. 7th Sept. at 7.30 pm. Location: Roe Valley Therapy Centre.**DUNGIVEN LIBRARY**Go Green' event for children on the first floor of our library on Saturday the 12th Sept. 12 noon – 1.25 pm. for children aged 6+ accompanied by an adult. *At the event, the children will get to : Plant a variety of seeds to take home and grow. Explore the hidden world around us using microscopes. Create their own gummy worms slime experiment. Make nature-inspired crafts to take home.*Booking essential Tel: 028 777 41475 e: dungiven.library@librariesni.org.uk**DUNGIVEN REGENERATION CLUB**Free Digital skills training sessions for older people and people with disabilities starting Tues. 8th Sept. To book a place Tel: 077 5969 2122.

Twenty - Second Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 30th August 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Tuesday at 9.30am. Thursday and First Friday at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Anniversary Mass: For Adrian Robinson on Sunday 30th August at 10am.

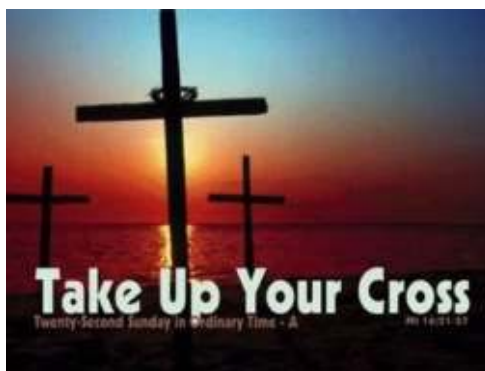
St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) -

First Anniversary Mass - For Susan McNicholl on Sunday 6th September at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Mary's Church in September.

Eucharistic Adoration: - No Adoration on Bank Holiday Monday.

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Sick Visitation: Fr. Crowley will attend the sick in his care on Thursday in the morning in Glenullin and the afternoon in Ballerin/Garvagh.

St. Mary's - September Altar Society: Carol Ann McLaughlin, Margeret Mullan, Dolores Mullan and Kate Mullan.

St. Mary's - September Collectors - (Vigil) Barney O'Kane.

(Sunday) Philip McKeown & Fergal Bradley.

St. Joseph's - September Altar Society: Fidelma O'Kane with Sheena & Aine Diane Burns.

St. Joseph's - September Counters: Fidelma O'Kane with Sheena & Aine Diane Burns.

St. Joseph's September Collectors: (Sunday) Seamus Conway, Padhraic and Thomas Leydon.

Parish Pastoral Group: Next meeting to prepare for the Parish Mission will take place on Tuesday 1st September in the Parochial House at 8.30pm.

Parish Mission: Parishioners may have heard that the parish will hold a mission in September of this year. It will be delivered by the Dominican Order. As you know it has been some time since the last Mission in the parish. Whilst members of the Parish Pastoral Group continue to organise it, it would be helpful to have a few interested individuals from each end of the parish to help with the organisation. Time commitment should not be great - a few hours between

now and September and some input during the week itself. This is a great opportunity to get involved in a significant event for the parish, and if you are interested, please contact Fr. Crowley.

Parish Mission - Sunday 27th September - Friday 2nd October.

Errigal SVP: School Uniform Support: As the new school year approaches, we know that the cost of school uniforms can place a significant financial burden on many families. If you or someone you know needs assistance with the cost of school uniforms, please don't hesitate to contact your local **St Vincent de Paul (SVP Errigal)** in confidence.

Telephone: 07563595868 All enquiries will be treated with sensitivity, respect and complete confidentiality.

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling.

No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided.

If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see <https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/>

Baby Massage & Reflexology Classes: 6-week course starting 9th September in Ballerin.

For more information or to book: diane@groundedsoles.org - 07761 054666

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish.

Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 5th September in St. Mary's Church at 5pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 13th September at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 2nd September at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Saturday 28th August using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September to 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, '*Living Water*', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'

The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. The conference will take place over two days in Saint Columb's College, Derry, with over 1200 delegates attending. Tuesday 25th August is the day for Post-Primary Schools and Wednesday 26th August is the day for Primary Schools. We are delighted to welcome Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College as our keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue on the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7pm.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 97 White - 72)

St. Mary's - Parish: £470 Renovation: £165

St. Joseph's - Parish: £360 Renovation: £385

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 1, 9, 17, 23. Jackpot is £2700. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Edel Mullan.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 5, 11, 18, 27. Jackpot £10,000. £20 winners - Gerard McAfee, Amanda McIlvar, Patricia McKeever, Dane Higgins, Naula O'Kane, Mickey Kealey, Eamon McGonigle (Desertmartin).

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 5th/6th September

Saturday Vigil - Anna Doherty.

Sunday Morning - Aileen Mullan.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 5th/6th September

Saturday Vigil - Louise Mullan & Corey Bradley.

Sunday Morning - Amanda Ferris & Kate McGill.

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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 5th/6th September

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Catriona Quigg.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead Mc Nicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 5th/6th September

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Diane Burns & Joanne Heaney.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Aidan of Lindisfarne: Was of Irish descent and was a monk of Iona. When Oswald, the exiled King of Northumbria who had fled for refuge to Iona, returned to his throne in 634, he invited Aidan to come to reconvert his people. Aidan made his headquarters at Lindisfarne. With the aid of the king as interpreter, he was very successful in his mission. He died in 651. **Thursday - St. Gregory the Great (540 - 604):** A Roman noble who was Prefect of the City before becoming a monk. As pope he established a pattern for the papacy in years to come. He sent missions to Lombardy, Sardinia and England. Patron of musicians. **Friday - St. Mac Nissi:** Oengus Mac Nissi took his name from his mother Cnes or Ness. It is claimed that Patrick baptised him and taught him the psalms. He chose the district of Connor for his hermitage but later became bishop of his clan. He died early in the sixth century. **Saturday - St. Teresa of Calcutta:** Anjeze Gonxhe Bojaxhiu was born 26th August 1910 in Skopje, Albania (now north Macedonia) and at eighteen years of age, came to Dublin to become a sister of Loreto with the singular desire to be a missionary in India. She founded in 1950 the Missionaries of Charity to serve the hungry, the unwanted and the dying. Often her faith was tested, her words and actions criticised, yet she was always certain in remaining a servant of Christ who reaches out to the poor. The Missionaries of Christ, once a small number in Calcutta, now number 5000 sisters in 130 countries.

Diocesan Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
<https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray>.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters*' - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titled Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed -
<https://youtube.com/@parishoferrigalderry>.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.

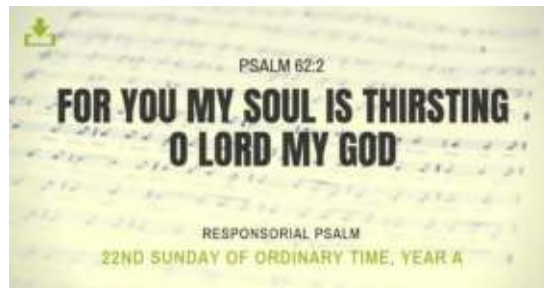
Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link:

<https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care-freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/>

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on <https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/>

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar [07841407154](tel:07841407154).

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the

General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website: www.synod.ie**



Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**

If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.

Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:

(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) **Errigal Development:** Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c).

(Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) **(Errigal Parish:** Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).

Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the

collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.

Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: <https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/> is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O’Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary’s Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph’s Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary’s Church.

<u>BAPTISMS</u> We welcome into God’s family the following children who were baptised: Fiann Georgie O’Donnell, Priory Close, Denham <i>May God guide and protect our children always</i>
<u>ADORATION IN ST MURA’S PARISH CHURCH</u> on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome. <u>THE PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP</u> Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty on Tuesday 1 September. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before mass, celebration of holy mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. Everyone welcome <u>MENS ROSARY</u> Saturday the 5th September @ 1pm Market Square, Letterkenny . <u>CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND</u>–Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For info and booking details, email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome. <u>SEASON OF CREATION 2026:</u> The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year’s theme, <i>Living Water</i>, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God’s creation.To mark the beginning of the season, the Three Patrons Parish Laudato Si’ group are inviting people to a short prayer service on Tues 1 Sept at 6:30pm in St Joseph’s Church, Galliagh. All are welcome <u>DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST</u> (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes. <u>BURT BINGO</u> every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm. <u>BURT’S BIG BINGO</u> Sunday 30th August at 3pm in St. Mary’s Hall, Burt. Two top prizes of €100. All other lines and houses are €25 and €50 respectively, except the 9th page €50 for the line and €100 for the house. The sheet is €25 for the line and €100 for the house. Great raffle prizes. Book €12 and sheet €2. Proceeds to Parish funds. To donate prizes for the raffle contact Carmel, Ellen or contact Kathleen on 086 3931426. <u>BURT GAA LOTTO</u> 1,7,14,19,25 weekly winners Caoilfhionn Lynch and Helen Gillespie €50 each <u>TABLE QUIZ</u> in An Grianan Hotel Thurs 3rd Sept at 9pm in aid of Burt Tennis Club. €5 per person. Light refreshments served. <u>SUPPORT THE ST MURA’S BELL PROJECT</u> Charity Cycle on Sunday, 30th August, starting and finishing at The Halfway House, Tooban. 15K route around Inch and a 62K advanced route, there is a challenge to suit all abilities. Entry is €35, with all funds going towards the St Mura’s Bell project. We warmly encourage parishioners, families and friends to take part, support the cyclists, and help make every mile count for this important project. 9am start – refreshments provided at the finish. Register online only @ https://eventmaster.ie/event/qZLksP7SQq <u>BEGINNERS LINE DANCING CLASS</u> at St Mary's Hall, Burt starting Thursday 3 Sept 7:45pm-8:45pm. <u>COFFEE MORNING</u> on Saturday 5th September 10am to 2pm in The Fowler Hall Tooban. All proceeds will help raise funds to support Paul Bradley, Gerard Curran, Kieran Toner and Oisín Bradley to travel to South Africa with the Niall Mellon Township Trust to help build a school for impoverished children. Everyone welcome. <u>A FEAST OF FOLK MUSIC</u> Final Show A Feast of Folk in The Cairn on Tuesday 1st Sept at 8pm Limited seating Telephone 9381104
<u>PRIVACY NOTICE:</u> The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura’s Church and St Aengus’ are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

http://www.fahanparish.com Fahan Parish Newsletter		
Weekly Collection Burt €1215 Inch €360 Fahan €990 <i>Sincere Thanks</i>	fahanparish@derrydiocese.org www.fahanparish.com 30th August 2026 Twenty Second Sunday In Ordinary Time	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9360151 (Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)
Mass Schedule		
<u>St. Aengus' Burt</u> <u>(churchservices.tv/burt)</u> Monday 31st Aug Mass at 10am Saturday 5th September Mass at 6.30pm Mary Porter 1st Anniversary Mass Elaine Sweeney Anniversary Mass Sunday 6th September Mass at 10.15am <u>Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch</u> Sunday 6th September Mass at 9am	<u>St Mura's Church, Fahan</u> <u>(churchservices.tv/fahan)</u> Wednesday 2nd September Mass at 7pm Friday 4th September Mass at 10am Peggy Doherty 35th Anniversary Mass Sunday 6th September Mass at 11:30am Patrick McGrory Month Mind Mass Mary T Mc Laughlin 7th Anniversary Mass <u>Chapel Of Ease, Fahan</u> Thursday 3rd September Mass at 10am	
LIAM GRANT'S MONTH MIND MASS WILL BE ON SUNDAY 6TH SEPTEMBER AT 12.30PM IN ST MARY'S ORATORY, BUNCRANA		
<u>BLESSING OF BIKES AND MOTORCYCLES</u> Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1:30pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 Sept in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.		
<u>CLIMB TO THE EUCHARISTIC CROSS</u> on Sunday 30th August meeting at the Water Tank at 1.30pm. The Rosary will be said on the way up. All Welcome.		
<u>ONE DAY PILGRIMAGE TO LOUGH DERG</u> The Buncrana Parish is running a one-day pilgrimage to Lough Derg on Saturday 5 September. Bus leaving The Oratory at 7:30am for arrival at the island at 9:30am. Cost for the day including return bus, boat fare, day pilgrimage and meal on way home is €85. For info and booking contact the Buncrana Parish Office on 0749361253. Spaces on a first-come first-served basis.		
FR BAKER WILL VISIT THE SICK IN HIS CARE ON FRIDAY 4TH SEPTEMBER IN THE INCH AREA FROM 10.30AM AND IN THE FAHAN AREA FROM 2.30PM		
<u>PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS</u> That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.		
<u>SAFEGUARDING NOTICE:</u> If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Sióchána, Buncrana 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 07491 02233		

Rev. Chris McDermott. Adm.

Tel: (028) 79401236

Email: christopher.mcdermott@derrydiocese.org

www.granaghanparish.com



Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 23rd August 2026

PARISH OF GRANAGHAN

St Vincent De Paul Helpline: 07927900310

MASS TIMES FOR THE COMING WEEK:

Monday, Wednesday & Friday Mass
at 09:15am
Saturday (Vigil) at 4pm
Sunday Mass at 11am

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? *We would like to help you.* Please pick up your phone and make contact - Tel: 028 7135 1329.

We welcome **Páidí Cameron**
as a member of **God's Family**



Drumnaph Nature Reserve

Forest Bathing Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through guided sensory meditations, reconnect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature!
Saturday 29 August | 10am - 12pm | £10

An Carn

Irish Language Classes with an emphasis on conversational Irish and building self-confidence starting on **21st September in An Carn**. Classes in high demand. Booking online essential.

Introduction to Willow Weaving: Berry Basket Perfect for those looking to make their own Berry Basket just in time for Foraging season. **Saturday 5 September**

Catholic Mothers Ireland - Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. **All are welcome.**

Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference 2026 - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope' The Derry Diocesan Catechetical Centre is delighted to be hosting its third Diocesan Schools' Religious Education Conference - 'Drawing New Maps of Hope'. **Tuesday 25th August** is the day for **Post-Primary Schools** and **Wednesday 26th August** is the day for **Primary Schools**. We are delighted to welcome **Dr Melodie Wyttenbach, Executive Director, Roche Centre for Catholic Education, Boston College** - keynote speaker. Bishop Donal McKeown will celebrate the Eucharist at the beginning of the conference each day. Alongside Dr Wyttenbach's keynote address, there will be 20 workshops, a panel discussion and the opportunity for attendees to meet and share their experiences and good practice. The conference begins at 9.30am and concludes at 3.00pm. **You are most welcome to call in to the conference at any stage over the two days.**

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND - Hosted by **Marriage Encounter Ireland** will take place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026. This Weekend is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online

In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father." **Fr Pat O'Hagan**

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP

We are delighted to confirm that we have organised another fabulous Upcycling Furniture DEMO on Wednesday evening, September 9th, 7-9pm, approximately. The Demo will be delivered by Sandra Hyndman. This Demo is part of our Housing Executive funded "Upcycling Our Active Community!" project and is totally FREE to all attendees! Places however are limited and booking essential. Phone Ann McNicholl to enquire or book: 07714757643

Weekly Collection for
Sunday 16th
Weekly: £1,103.90
Thank you
for your
generous support

Comhaltas Ceoltóirí Éireann, An Suaitreach - Musicians of Ireland

Registration now open for music classes beginning Wednesday 23rd September. Scan the code to find out more and to complete the registration form.

Closing date 11th September. To find out more and to complete the registration form. Contact - Comhaltas Ceoltóirí Éireann

Please note: Bulletin will not be printed for Sunday 30th August

Catholic Faith Sharing

GREENLOUGH and BALLYSCULLION PARISH NEWSLETTER
SUNDAY 30 AUGUST 2026 **22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time**

Tel: 028 2582 1190. email: greenloughparish@gmail.com
(028) 79386259. email: info@bellaghyparish.com

Church Island Sunday will be celebrated today (30 August). Anyone wishing to take part is invited to gather on Ballydermott Road at 2pm.

MASS SCHEDULE: 31 AUGUST - 6 SEPTEMBER 2026

GREENLOUGH

Tuesday 1 September: 9.30am; Rosary: 7.30pm

Thursday 3 September: Adoration - 9.00am to 5.00pm

Friday 4 September: 9.30am.

Saturday 5 September: Vigil Mass - 5.30pm: (streamed to Bellaghy): *Anniversary Mass for Barry O'Neill, Francie O'Neill & Mary O'Neill*

Sunday 6 September: 11.00am (streamed from Bellaghy)

BELLAGHY

Monday 31 August: 9.30am; Wednesday 2 September: 9.30am

Friday 4 September, Adoration, 10am – 8pm.

Saturday 5 September: 5.30pm (streamed from Greenlough)

Sunday 6 September: 11.00am (streamed to Greenlough)

BALLYSCULLION

Sunday 6 September: 9.45am

Fr Pat is going on pilgrimage to **Medjugorje** from 4 – 11 September, and will bring the intentions of all our parishioners to Our Blessed Lady.

Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Anniversaries: Thomas James McCloskey, John Joseph McErlean, Kathleen McCloskey, Brigid Marron.

Lawrence Mulholland, Mary Ann O'Neill, Tommy McCann, Annie Diamond, Mary Woulahan. Sinead and Clodagh Rose Milne (Anniversary Mass at 11am, 30 August).

Greenlough Collection - 23/8/26: £728.72.

Counters for September: Eileen Reid, Bridie McAlynn, Michael Henry

Clady Church Cleaning Team for September: Bridie McAlynn.

Volunteers Needed: Would you be willing to help with the cleaning of St Oliver Plunkett Church in September? Please contact Declan in the Sacristy or email the parish office.

Bellaghy Church Cleaners for September: Maria McMullan & Tracy McErlean.

The Greenlough Parish Office is currently closed but you can contact us via phone: **028 2582 1190**, email, or message us on our parish **Facebook page**.

The Bellaghy Parish Office will reopen on Thursday 3 September.

Please send Notices & Anniversaries by phone, in writing, or via email to the parish office by 10.00am on Wednesday. Thank you.

Bann Valley Community Group: Please join us in **Clady Hall** on **Wednesday 2nd September at 7.30pm** for an information event hosted by the **RSPB on the plans for Moneystaghan Wood**. They are keen for as much local engagement as possible.

Bingo - Marian Hall, Kilrea makes a welcome return on Thursday 17 September at 8.30pm, every 2 weeks. Double books £20, Single £10, Half books £5. Last House £250.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from **1 September to 4 October**, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, ***Living Water***, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

ROSARY VIGIL FOR LIFE - outside **Belfast City Hall** on **Sunday 30th August at 2.00pm**. Join Precious Life in prayer to uphold the sacredness and dignity of unborn life, and pray that Belfast Council will reject plans to illuminate the City Hall in celebration of abortion. For more information, **contact 028 9027 8484 / 07592 280522 or email info@preciouslife.com**.

The Rosary will be recited outside Belfast City Hall at 1pm on Monday 31 August, to join people in prayer for Life, Justice, and Truth.

Donegal Rise and Shine Trust (The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. Mass on **Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny, at 12 noon**. The Mass will be concelebrated by **Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown**, and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. Everyone welcome.

The Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Church, Ballymagroarty will take place on **Tuesday 1 September 2026**. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass at 7.15pm. Blessing with a First Class relic of St. Pio while closing prayers are recited. Everyone Welcome.

The Men's Rosary will be recited in **Bellaghy**, at **1.00pm**, on **Saturday 5 September**, at the **junction of Main St and Castle St**, to honour the Blessed Virgin Mary and pray for peace, justice, and respect for Life.

Dates for baptism: Bellaghy – at 1pm on 26 Sept; 10 Oct; 7 Nov; 5 Dec.
Greenlough – 12.30pm on 13 Sept; 4;15pm on 24 Oct; 28 Nov; 19 Dec.

We pray for **Bishop Dónal McKeown** as he prepares to retire, and for **Bishop Michael Router** as he prepares to begin his ministry among us as Bishop of Derry. His installation will take place in St Eugene's Cathedral, at 3pm, on Sunday 20 September. Each parish is invited to send 5 parishioners to the Mass of Installation. If interested, please contact your parish office.

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

SEASON OF CREATION 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite:

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, details www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

Sun 30th Aug

Vol 44 No 35

MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm

Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

DO WE DIRECT JESUS OR FOLLOW HIS DIRECTIONS?

Peter has just confessed that Jesus is the Christ, yet he cannot accept that the Messiah must suffer and die. He wants the glory of Christ without the Cross. Jesus tells him, "Get behind me," calling Peter back to his proper place: not directing Jesus, but following him. When Jesus asks us to deny ourselves, he is not asking us to hate ourselves or believe we are worthless. Rather, he asks us to surrender the false self that must always succeed, remain in control and avoid weakness. Taking up the cross means accepting the cost of loving faithfully, trusting that Christ walks before us. The Gospel contains a paradox: when we cling to life on our own terms, we lose it; when we entrust ourselves to Christ, we discover life. The question is not simply whether Jesus accompanies my plans, but whether I am willing to follow where he leads.

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes: Fiadh Majella Millar Synge Court

EUCCHARISTIC MINISTERS FOR SEPTEMBER

Vigil Mass Paul Kite, Liam Whoriskey, Rose White

9:30am Brenda Brady, Andrea Devlin

11:00am Doreen Rice Wray, Margaret Hamilton, Eugene Mellon

12:30am Ann Gallagher, Margaret Harkin

READERS FOR September

Vigil Mass Sr. Ann **9.30am** Brenda Coyle

11am Jackie Conway **12.30pm** Patricia Murphy

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Dolores Tracey, Tony McGrellis, Brian Dillon, Frances Thompson, Bronco Bradley, Kathleen Toye, Eileen Hughes, Eugene McSherry Paul Coyle, John Dixon, Sarah Jane Campbell

SUNDAY COLLECTION 23rd August £2303.26 Standing Orders £400 and €154.29 Thank you for your generosity

MESSAGE FROM FRANSELM MEO who was here a number of years ago. 'I am writing to you asking for your support for us. As you have known recently Flores island in Indonesia has been hit by earthquake in Saturday, August 15th, 2026. Up to now, the earthquake still going on and we live in tents due to the condition of the old parochial house. I now work in Datak Parish of Labuan Bajo Diocese. Some of the members of my family are in Mbay and they all in refugees without home. I, therefore on behalf of me and our parishioners and the people in Archdiocese of Ende, come to you Father and the parishioners of Holy Family, asking for support'. Envelopes are available at the back of the church for anyone who would like to contribute. You can return envelopes next weekend in the collection or drop them into the parish office.

CHILD SAFE GUARDING REFRESHER TRAINING

In 2023 all Parish Volunteers, Clergy and Employees received Child Safe guarding Training. It is necessary that this training is refreshed every three years. With this in mind all Parish Volunteers and Clergy and Employees are asked to attend refresher training in Holy Family Primary School on Thursday 10th September at 8.00pm. Please leave your name in the Parish Office to indicate your availability to attend.

HOLY FAMILY PADRE PIO GROUP Monthly devotions Tuesday 1st Sept. Rosary at 6:45pm and Mass at 7:15 Followed by Novena Prayers and Blessing with Relic of St Pio.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD."

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

ROSARY VIGIL FOR LIFE - outside Belfast City Hall on Sunday 30th August at 2.00pm. Join Precious Life in prayer pray that Belfast Council will reject plans to illuminate the City Hall in celebration of abortion. For more info Tel 028 9027 8484 /07592 280522b info@preciouslife.com

ANAM CARA Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings Tuesday 15 September at 7pm. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30pm. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on **Sunday, 6 September** at **Termonbacca**. The day will begin with **Mass at 2.00pm**, celebrated by **Bishop Donal McKeown**, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For more information email info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome

IMPORTANT NOTICE - OUR DIOCESAN DESIGNATED PERSON
SAFEGUARDING REPRESENTATIVE IS: Marie O'Kane
Telephone: (044)7596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT: After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Iskaheen on Tuesday until 2.00 p.m. **CHAPLET OF DIVINE MERCY:** After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Muff on Thursday.

PARISH DRAW RESULTS - WEEK 43: €300 – Siobhan O'Hagan, Sappagh, €200 – Margaret Doherty, Ballyboe, €100 – Anne Marie McGill, Aught.

SCOIL NAOMH FIONÁN & SCOIL NAOMH BRÍD

Scoil Naomh Fionán and Scoil Naomh Bríd will re-open shortly for the New School Year. Welcome back to all the pupils and staff and a **BIG WELCOME** to our Junior Infants, and all new members of staff.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

BUNCRANA GARDEN FETE 2026: The Annual Garden Fete will take place this Sunday, 23 August, from 3.00 - 6.00pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire, Bunrana F93 PN53. Fun for all the family with Bouncy Castles, Mechanical Bull, Petting Farm, Facepainting, Bingo, Rickety Wheel, Children's Games, Raffle Prizes and more. Entry €5pp or €15 per family (cash only). All welcome.

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place next weekend of 29 /30 August.

SIGNED MASS CARDS AND MASS BOUQUETS AVAILABLE IN ISKAHEEN PAROCHIAL HOUSE AND DRUNG SACRISTY.

To book Weddings, Baptisms, Month's Mind Masses, Anniversary Masses, contact Anne at the Parish Office on 9384037.

PARISH OF ISKAHEEN & UPPER MOVILLE

Iskaheen, Drung & Muff Churches
(*St. Patrick's, St. Columba's & Sacred Heart*)

Twenty-First Sunday in Ordinary Time

Parish Priest: Fr. John Farren P.P. - Tel: 9384037
Parish Secretary: Mrs Anne Clarke 10.00 a.m.- 2.00 p.m.
(Tuesday to Friday - Tel: 9384037)

E-mail: iskaheenparish@derrydiocese.org

Websites: www.iskaheenparish.com & www.stcolumbasdrung.net

Live Streaming www.mcn.live

Scoil Naomh Fionán, Principal: Mr Patrick Patton - Tel: 9383228.

Scoil Naomh Bríd, Principal: Mr Gary Foster - Tel: 9384136.

(Drung Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 4079904)

(Muff Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 3040627)

23rd August 2026 - Year A - Schedule for the Coming Week

MASS TIMES:	DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Saturday: (Vigil):	5.00 p.m.	-----	6.30 p.m.
Sunday: (Morning)	10.15 a.m.	9.00 a.m.	11.30 a.m.

DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Monday 24 th August : 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Tuesday 25 th August: -----	10.00 a.m.	-----
Wednesday 26 th August: 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Thursday 27 th August: 12.00 p.m.	-----	10.00 a.m.
Friday 28 th August: 1.00 p.m.	-----	10.00 a.m.
Saturday 29 th August: 5.00 p.m.	1 pm /10 am. ES	6.30 p.m.

CONFESSIONS: DRUNG

Before 5.00 p.m. Mass on Saturday

CONFESSIONS: MUFF

Before 6.30 p.m. Mass on Saturday

NB THE NEXT ST. PEREGRINE NOVENA MASS & BLESSING WITH THE RELIC WILL BE HELD ON FRIDAY 11th SEPTEMBER IN ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, ISKAHEEN AT 7.00 P.M.

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Twenty-Second Sunday of The Year

30th August 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com

E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com

Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*

Telephone: 028 29540343

Errigal: 028 29558251

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

Monday, Thursday and Friday at 10am in Saint Anne's Oratory.

In Remembrance of

Eugene Larkin, Philip McWilliams, Jimmy McGrath, Mary Burke, Owen McWilliams, Bobby Rainey, Teresa McAtamney, Johnny Cassidy, Margaret Mooney and Noel Quigg whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Our parish family welcomes
Elle Mae Leacock
who was baptised recently.



May she always walk as a child the light!

Kilrea GAC News

Lottery result 20th August: 3,13,20,26.

No Winner £3,850

£25 – Una McAtasney £25 – Anne Lowery

Next Jackpot is £3,900. **Tickets on Klubfunder.**

Vocations Prayer: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.... Fr Pat O'Hagan.

Last week's collection amounted to £1,730.

Thank You

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of **Mary Convery, Drumagarner Road & Deirdre Smyth, Bridge Street** who were buried recently.
May they rest in peace and rise in glory

First Anniversary Mass for **Danny Burke** on Friday 25th September at 7.30pm Drumagarner.

JOB OPPORTUNITY: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Bingo makes a welcome return on Thursday 17th September at 8.30pm, every 2 weeks in the Marian Hall. Double books £20, Single £10, Half books £5. Last House £250

Readers for 05th Sept/ 06th Sept

7pm:

Colm Ross

10am:

Pauline Quigg

12noon:

Padraig Quigg

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will pause during July & August for the summer break.

Weekly adoration resumes on Monday 7th September.

Mass Times
Sundays:
Vigil: 6.00pm
Morning:
9am & 11am

Weekdays:
Mon - Fri:
9.15am

Baptisms
Sundays
11.45am

Telephone
No's
Fr. Graham
028 7964 2458

Parish Office:
028 7964 2458

SVP Helpline
07596971627

St. Brigid's PS.
028 7964 2014

Lavey Early
Years
028 7964 5464

Neighbouring
Parishes

Maghera
Fr. Doherty
028 7964 2496

Kilrea
Fr. McDermott
028 2954 0343

ST BRIGID'S PS.

Term starts for all pupils on
Tuesday 1st September at 9.15am.

P1 pupils will go home at **12 noon**, **P2** and **P3** pupils will go home at **2pm**.

Morning Club is available from **1st September** from **8.15am - 9am** at a cost of **£2 per morning**. This must be booked in advance. **Booking forms are available from the school office.**



"From an Island to an Island" Journeying from Lavey to Newfoundland

Stories, poems, singing and much more

Sunday 13th September
in Lavey Club at 7.30pm

All Donations in aid of
 Lavey Parish.

Come along for a night of entertainment!



Parish Details

Please have all Anniversaries names & News Items in **by 1.00 pm on WEDNESDAY** this week.



The Parish Office is open
Monday - Thursday from 10.00 am.

Thank-You



Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458

E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org

Web: www.laveyparish.com



"What will you gain if you win the whole world and ruin your life?" Our society promotes three things as the sources of human happiness and fulfilment: positions of importance and power; money and possessions; continuous pleasure. Obviously, all of these are important for the human person. But, when they become the reason for living, they are full of false promise. Jesus calls on us to put our trust in the important things of life, especially love, and to find there our true fulfilment. We engage in this struggle in all kinds of ways but especially in matters of love and faith. Spending time at prayer, either personal or as a community, can be seen as wasting opportunities for other things that could bring us rewards. Giving time to one another in marriage and family life is often done reluctantly because of what we might be missing. And yet these are the really important things of life. Do we believe this?

Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.



Monday 31st August **9.15 am Mass**
 Tuesday 1st September **7.00pm Mass**
Month's Mind Mass for Ellen Scullion
 Wednesday 2nd September **9.15 am Mass**
 Thursday 3rd September **9.15 am Mass**
 Friday 4th September **9.15 am Mass**
Adoration will begin after morning Mass and conclude at 5.00 pm.
7.00pm Mass
Month's Mind Mass for Mary Shannnon

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time
(Masses in Lavey Club)

Saturday 5th September **5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
6:00 pm Mass
 Sunday 6th September **9:00 pm Mass**
11:00 am Mass

Sick and the Housebound

Fr. Graham will attend the sick and the
 housesbound this **Wednesday 2nd**
and Thursday 3rd September.



Parish Collections: Sunday 23rd August

Weekly: **£905.00**
 Building: **£955.10**
 Loose Coin: **£491.49**

Thank you for your continued support!



Sunday 30th August - 22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

******* ICE-CREAM SUNDAY *******

Saturday 5th & Sunday 6th September

All weekend Masses will be celebrated in
 Lavey/Termoneeny Centre.

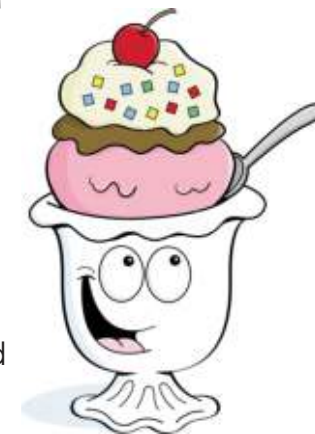
Knickerbocker Glory, Ice-cream
 Sundaes,

Tea/Coffee & Desserts will be served
after 6.00pm & 11.00am Mass.

Tea/Coffee & Traybakes will be served
after 9.00am Mass.

All welcome!

All Donations in aid of the Parish Fund.



JOB OPPORTUNITY: Derry Diocesan Trust
Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan,
hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of
work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of
Pay : £12.88 per hour.



For application packs please email:

recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone: **028 7126 2302.**
 Completed applications must be returned to **Personnel, Bishop's**
House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP
 or via email to **recruitment@derrydiocese.org** no later than
12noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will
 take place on **Sunday 13th September** in **St**
Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at
1:30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief
 service and blessing. Following the blessing
 all are welcome to join the run to Ned's
 Point RNLI Station, to present the donation
 to the RNLI.



Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-Second Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 30th August 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 16:21-27)

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love. Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice. Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word **PROFIT** guide our reflection.

True PROFIT is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is **Pursuing** God's purpose, **Rejecting** empty paths, **Offering** our lives, **Following** faithfully, **Investing** in what lasts, and **Treasuring** our souls. When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

***May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind,
so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 2nd September at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Feast of St Pio – Wednesday 23rd September To celebrate the feast of St Pio, a triduum of prayer will take place in the parishes of our pastoral area on days beforehand – more details next week. Mass to celebrate the feast day will take place on Wednesday 23rd September at 7 pm in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am - 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Rd.** Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am - 1.00 pm**. Everyone welcome.

We wish every blessing on all the students, teachers and school staff of our parish pastoral area, as they return to school. God bless for the year ahead.

Prayer for a New School Year We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days. As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave. During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. Amen.

Requiescat in Pace Martin Gallagher, Bingley, Yorkshire (formerly of Laurel Drive)

Anniversaries Margaret Connolly, Dympna Coyle, Edward Crawford, Wilma Dolan, John Gallagher, Philomena Gallagher, Pat Gillespie, Patrick Holland, John Kelly, Robert McClay Jnr, Mary McDaid, Anne McElhinney, Hughie McElhinney, George McGilloway, Teresa McGonagle, Anna Patton, Hannah Patton, Harry Patton, Margaret Tighe. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to recent collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,307.14 (23/8/26), £1,306.96 (9/8/26), £1,507.68 (2/8/26)

Clonleigh: €1,561.34 (23/8/26), €1,455.84 (9/8/26), €1,593.41 (2/8/26)

Camus: £1,508.47 (23/8/26), £1,727.60 (9/8/26), £1,731.47 (2/8/26)

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 6th September:

1st Reading: Ezekiel 33:7-9

Psalm: 95:1-2, 6-7, 8-9

2nd Reading: Romans 13:8-10

Gospel: Matthew 18:15-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Donegal Down's Syndrome Assoc Annual Church Gate Collection this weekend at St Patrick's Murlog. Your support for this important fundraising event is greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down's syndrome and their families across Donegal.

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, 'Living Water', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. You are warmly invited to the streaming of **World Council of Churches online service** marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm at The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU. For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com RSVP: 07711900420.

A Prayer for our Earth (Pope Francis, Laudato Si, 246)

(Tuesday 1st September - World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation)

All-powerful God, you are present in the whole universe and in the smallest of your creatures. You embrace with your tenderness all that exists. Pour out upon us the power of your love, that we may protect life and beauty. Fill us with peace, that we may live as brothers and sisters, harming no one. O God of the poor, help us to rescue the abandoned and forgotten of this earth, so precious in your eyes.

Bring healing to our lives, that we may protect the world and not prey on it, that we may sow beauty, not pollution and destruction. Touch the hearts of those who look only for gain at the expense of the poor and the earth.

Teach us to discover the worth of each thing, to be filled with awe and contemplation, to recognise that we are profoundly united with every creature as we journey towards your infinite light. We thank you for being with us each day.

Encourage us, we pray, in our struggle for justice, love, and peace.

Come and See Have you heard about the Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren't sure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come and see' before you make your decision. Classes will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 - 9.00 pm beginning on 3rd September in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham. First half hour is prayer and worship. Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. Application deadline: October 1st. Tuition fees will then be applied. More information or register at <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sun 13th Sept at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. All welcome. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on 13th Sept at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year. All welcome.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on Tuesday 1st September starting with Rosary at 6.45 pm, celebration of Mass at 7.15 pm followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September at 12 noon in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny. Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats August 31; September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 - a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice Join us on Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm at Murphy's on the Green. Prize draw: £1 per line. All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day: Sun 6 September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hours per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. For application pack, please contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org or 028 71262302. Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary will take place on Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm at Market Square, Letterkenny. Everyone welcome.

Blood Cancer Awareness Month Strabane Fundraising Branch will hold a sponsored walk on Friday 4th September at 7.00 pm starting from MK's Bar on the Derry Road. Suitable for all. Please join us.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention: **For the care of water**. Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Cancer Focus NI - Pink Colour Fun Run takes place at Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October. Details available at www.cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (30th Aug - alternate Sundays - 13th Sept)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept - alternate Sundays – 20th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

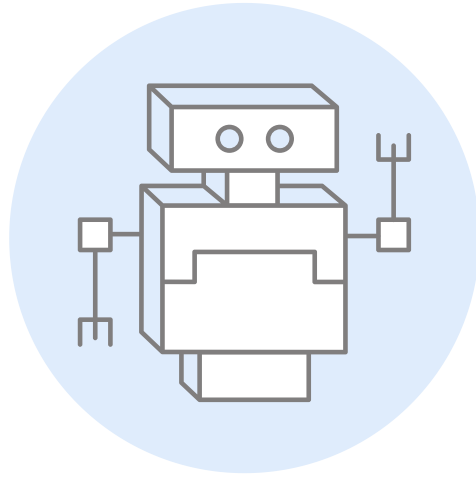
Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



longtowerchurch.org

Checking the site connection security



Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
 Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
 Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
 Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
 PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish

It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

In this Sunday's gospel, Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "the keys of the Kingdom" "an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord was, He will" place the key of David on the shoulder of those called to Lead His people, those who will be called "father".

Rev. Pat O'Hagan

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY – 9.30am Mass on Saturday 5 September will be offered for all Members of Derry Diocesan Society.

HOLY FACE OF JESUS - Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

<u>FEASTS:</u>	Thursday	27 August: St Monica
	Friday	28 August: St Augustine
	Saturday	29 August: The Passion of St John the Baptist

TRÓCAIRE – Thank you all for taking the time and care to give £12,100 to Trocaire this Lent and help Uwamahoro family's build a better life beyond poverty and climate injustice. Yor generosity and grace will forever be part of their story. Thank you so much Fr. Doherty, and the people of Maghera Parish. We'd be lost without your love. Seán Farrell (CEO, Trocaire)

LEGION OF MARY, Maghera is organising a trip to Knock on Sunday 27 September 2026. The Bus will leave Glen chapel at 7am and travel via Dungiven. Cars can be parked in the Chapel car park. We usually return to Glen around 10pm. The fare which will be £25 will be collected on the bus. Bring a packed lunch. We will get the 50 - seater bus which is more comfortable if we have sufficient numbers. To book your seat phone 796742983 or 07748273706 before 24 September. (leave a message if no reply). There will be a toilet stop in Bundoran on the way down and a longer stop on the way home. Food of your choice can be had in any of the local hotels or cafes.

'Embrace the Grace' Young adult Catholic Conference – 29 August – Legion of Mary:

'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Any queries can be directed to: deusetpatria@mail.com

ENVELOPE COLLECTION Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,484. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded. Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am

GLEN GAA Website www.wattvgrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 42:29:23:48:

No winner. Next week £9,500 4 winners of £50: Terence Regan: Mary Mallon: Paul Hurley and Sinead McGill. Flyover next week £16,500 in 45 Numbers or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

AN CARN - Introduction to Willow Weaving a berry basket. Perfect for those looking to make their own berry basket just in time for foraging season! Saturday 5 Sept 9.30am – 5.00pm at An Carn 18+ Cost £25. **Live Music: Na Leanai** - The children and grandchildren of the Sands Family, a name synonymous with Irish folk music for generations, are joining us at An Coire for a special night of music you don't want to miss! Sat 12 Sept. Doors open at 7.00pm. Cost £16. Under 16s free.

Drumnaph Nature Reserve - Forest Bathing – Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through guided sensory meditations, re-connect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature! Saturday 29 August 10.00am – 12noon. Cost £10.

Irish Language Classes: – with an emphasis on conversational Irish and building self-confidence - on 21 September in An Carn. Classes in high demand. Booking essential.

OUT & ABOUT COMMUNITY TRANSPORT. – Looking for a wee lift out – hospital/ GP appointments, essential shopping, social outings, visiting family, dentist/eye appointments, community events etc. call **Out & About**, Unit15, Station Road Industrial Estate, Magherafelt BT45 5EY – Just telephone 028 79300123 info@outandaboutct.org

GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP – We are delighted to confirm that we organised another fabulous upcycling Furniture DEMO on Wed 9 September from 7pm to 9pm, approximately. The Demo will be delivered by Sandra Hyndman. This Demo is part of our housing Executive funded Upcycling Our Active Community! project and is totally FREE to all attendees! Places however are limited and booking essential Phone Ann McNicholl to enquire book - 07714757643

DEERRY DIOCESAN TRUST = SACRISTAN REQUIRED – for St John the Baptist Church, Granaghan, Swatragh. Rate of pay £12.88 per hour. 12 Hours per week. For application packs contact: Bishop's Office, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry BT48 9AP – Telephone 02871262302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

FUNDRAISING CONCERT – MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND - in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught on Friday 2 October. Commences 8pm. Doors open 7.15pm. Tickets £30. Book online with Eventbrite (<https://www.eventbrite.co.uk>) Search for: Michael English, Keenaught.

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND FAMILY DAY: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email: info@catholicmothers.ie All welcome!

22nd Sunday in Ordinary Time

30 August 2026

Welcome Back

After the summer break, it is good to be back with our weekly reflection and the Gospel this Sunday is a great place to restart.

Last week we heard Peter's great confession: "*You are the Christ.*" This week, only moments later in the same conversation, the same Peter gets it badly wrong. Jesus speaks of the cross, and Peter takes him aside to talk him out of it. "*Get behind me, Satan,*" Jesus replies. Peter, the rock, has become a stumbling block!

There is great comfort in that. Peter is not a baddie here; he is a man who loves Jesus and cannot bear the thought of him suffering. His mistake is one we all make: wanting God on our terms, wanting faith without cost, wanting the crown without the cross.

Jesus does not reject Peter. He simply tells him to get back where a disciple belongs: behind the Master, following, not leading.

Jeremiah knew the same struggle. In the first reading he complains that God has seduced him, that being a prophet has brought him nothing but insult and derision. He decides to say no more and then finds a fire burning in his heart that he cannot hold in. Faith is like that. It costs, and yet we cannot walk away from it, because it is life itself.

"Anyone who loses his life for my sake will find it." As a new school and parish year begins, that is the question the Gospel puts to each of us: where am I spending my life? On things that will pass, or on the One who lasts?

Welcome back and every blessing as we continue our journeys. May we find life by giving it away for God.

Fr Sean

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We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Cait Cooke, Oliver Terence Coyle Burrows, Max Dean Harkin, Mia Jean Hoynes

Lochlan Eamon Sweeney, Logan Samuel Warden, Adi Bobjee Gary McKearney

Darragh Stephen Kearney, Leo Naoise McCrossan, Wren Kerri McLaughlin

Amelia Patricia Turnbull, Ava Michelle Turnbull, Ada Helen Mullen

Amelia Bernadette McDonnell, Cian Thomas Martin, Blaine Michael Kelly

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Terry McGonigle, 59 Carrick Strand

Pat Quinn, 24 Ashgrove Park

Frank Connolly, 1 Glebe Park

Anthony McGillian, 23 Innisfree Gardens

Garvan O'Connor, 35 Castlegrange Park

Jane O'Friel, Lifford

Michael Boyce, Laurel Drive

Michael (Mixer) McCrossan, 4 Marian Park

John Duncan, 18 Church View

Harry Mullen, 300 Victoria Road

Charlie Gillespie, 33 Belldoo

Laurence Gallagher, 16 Drumman Court

Maureen Duffy, 32 Ballycolman Road

Tommy Curley, Lisnafin Park

Margaret Sweeney, 66 Glebe Gardens

Leo O'Kane, Wicklow, formerly Bridge Street

Speedy Rouse, 22 Upper Main Street

Anniversaries

Columba O'Neill, Thomas James Devlin, Gerard Kearney

Annie Mary Elliott, Liam Corry, Danny Carlin

Mark McGrath, Geraldine McBrearty, Damien McGrath

Tony McAleer, Ruby Duffy, Raymond Allen, Sheila McHugh

Willie Christy, Joe McShane, Owen Sweeney

Willie Doyle, Pearl McAneny, Aidan Callaghan

Arthur O'Kane, Paddy Connolly, Dymphna Coyle

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Vocations We pray that the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

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To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

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Tuesday 1 September – Year 8 and Peer Mentors

Wednesday 2 September – Years 8, 12, 13 & 14

Thursday 3 September – Years 9, 10, 11, 12, 13 & 14

Friday 4 September – All Year Groups

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly *The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust* and *The Irish Pilgrimage Trust*) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. For more information and booking details email:
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This year's theme '*Living Water*' invites us to give thanks for the gift of water.

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Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 30th As the day of Resurrection, Sunday is not only a remembrance of a past event; it is a celebration of the living presence of the risen Lord in the midst of his own people. For this presence to be properly proclaimed it is important that the disciples of Christ, saved as the people of God, come together to express fully the very identity of the Church (Pope St John Paul II).

Monday 31st St Aidan of Lindisfarne was of Irish descent and a monk of Iona. When Oswald, the exiled king of Northumbria who had fled for refuge to Iona, returned to his throne in 634, he invited Aidan to come to reconvert his people. Aidan made his headquarters at Lindisfarne. With the aid of the king as interpreter he was very successful. He died in 651.

Tuesday 1st September Today, the *World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation*, The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

Thursday 3rd St Gregory the Great (540-604). A Roman nobleman, who was Prefect of the City before becoming a monk. He became Pope in 590; he established a pattern for the papacy in the years to come and his influence lasted long after his death. He had a strong influence on the Roman liturgy and he sent missionaries to Lombardy, Sardinia and England.

Friday 4th St Mac Nissi. Oengus Mac Nissi took his name from his mother Cnes or Ness. It is claimed that Patrick baptised him and taught him the psalms. He chose the district of Connor (Co. Antrim) for his hermitage and later became bishop.

Saturday 5th St Teresa of Calcutta (1910 – 1997), founded the Missionaries of Charity to serve the hungry, unwanted and dying.

Sunday 6th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballybrack. Reader at this Mass will be Harry McCormick
 First Anniversary Mass for Marion Doherty.

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am. **Confessions** in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm. **The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet** will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Mary Frances Doherty, Carnagarve who died recently. May she rest in peace.

The next **Parish Draw**, the last in the series, will take place on **Monday 14 September.**
 Promoters, please hand in your list on or before that date.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €2936 and a donation of €30.

The **Padre Pio** Devotion takes place in Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty on Tuesday 1 September with Rosary at 6.45pm followed by Mass 7.15pm and blessing with a relic of St. Pio.

Prayer for Vocations: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. We pray to the Lord.

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Final Show *A Feast of Folk* with Patsy Cavanagh and friends in The Cairn, at 8pm on Tuesday 1 September. Ballads and Folk songs from Ireland and further afield as seating is limited, please call 9381104.

Names are being taken for **Bridge Classes**, commencing mid-September. To register for classes or for further information please contact Margaret on 0863936255 as soon as possible.

As September approaches with the long evenings, why not sign up for **Irish** conversation classes. Classes depend on numbers. Contact gerrysona123@yahoo.ie if interested.

On Saturday 5 September there will be an **evening of praise**, singing hymns and exploring some of the powerful stories behind them in Greenbank Presbyterian Church Hall, Quigley's Point. Collection towards humanitarian and missionary work in Myanmar.

Pilgrimage to **Doon Well and Ards** on Sunday 4 October. Contact Bridie McNally, 9383158.

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) The Sunday Night Dance takes place tonight, Sunday, 30 August, at 8pm. Admission €5 including supper. A wide variety of courses is planned for the autumn. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

First Saturday Rosary on Saturday 5 September at 1pm in Market Square, Letterkenny.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie – Baby Reflexology begins on Tuesday 1 September. Call 0863137817 to register. Mindful Maker crafting and upcycling course, 6 weeks from Monday 14 September. Cost €30. Sewing Club resumes on Wednesday 9 September at 7pm. Call 00447752682086 to book.

Adoration Chapel

On Monday we open the new Adoration Chapel in St Pius X Church. From now on this is where we will have the exposition of the Blessed Sacrament each Monday and Wednesday at the usual times, as well as the recitation of the Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet each evening. The Adoration Chapel can be accessed at the rear of the sacristy. Please follow the direction signs.

I will officially bless the Chapel at the end of the 10.00am mass on Monday and I hope it will become a well-used prayer space in the years ahead. The main church will remain open throughout the daytime for those who wish to come and spend some time in private prayer, but with the darker evenings the church will close at 6.00pm whilst the Adoration Chapel will remain open until the usual finish times each evening.

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CATHOLICIRELAND.NET
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[Click here to view Daily Readings from CatholicIreland.net](#)

[Click here to view Sunday Readings from CatholicIreland.net](#)

Site Links

- 1 Latest News
- 2 Remembering our Dead.
- 3 WEBCAM
- 4 Prayers For Protection
- 5 Mass Times
- 6 Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 16:21-27

In today's Gospel, Jesus reminds us that following him is not always the easy path. He speaks honestly about suffering, sacrifice and the cross, and calls his disciples to take up their own cross and follow him with courage and trust.

These words can challenge us. We naturally want a life free from difficulty, yet Jesus shows us that true love often involves self-giving and putting others before ourselves. Taking up our cross does not mean seeking out suffering, but faithfully responding to the demands of love, forgiveness, service and faithfulness in the circumstances of our daily lives.

Jesus also asks a profound question: What will it profit us to gain the whole world but lose our true selves? In a world that can place great value on success, possessions, comfort and recognition, the Gospel calls us to step back and remember what truly matters. Our relationship with God and the way we love others are worth far more than anything the world can offer.

May we have the courage to follow Christ faithfully, especially when the path is difficult, trusting that the way of the cross ultimately leads to life. And may our everyday acts of love, kindness and service become a quiet witness to the hope we have in him.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Save the Date: Saint Carlo Acutis Day of Prayer. You are invited to come to St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry on Sunday 11th October from 2.00pm where we will have Veneration of a First Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis, gifted to the Cathedral by Carlo's mother, Antonia. The Sacrament of Confession will be available from 2.00pm until Mass at 7.00pm, which will be celebrated by Bishop Michael Ruter. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in the Mother Teresa Chapel during the Celebrations. A short film on Carlo's life will be shown in the Conference Room. Everyone is welcome to this special time.

St Teresa of Calcutta: A Life of Love. On 5th September, the Church celebrates the memorial of St Teresa of Calcutta, a woman whose life was a remarkable witness to Christ's love for the poor, the sick and the forgotten.

Born in Skopje in 1910, Mother Teresa dedicated her life to serving those most in need. Through the Missionaries of Charity, she sought to see Christ in every person she encountered, especially those who were suffering or abandoned. Her simple message was powerful: we are called to do small things with great love.

Her life reminds us that holiness is not always found in extraordinary deeds, but in the faithful, loving actions of everyday life. A kind word, a visit to someone who is lonely, an act of forgiveness, or practical help offered to someone in need can all become expressions of God's love.

As we remember St Teresa this September, may her example encourage us to look around our own communities with compassionate eyes and generous hearts. May we recognise Christ in those we meet and, in whatever small ways we can, bring something of His love and mercy to others.

St Teresa of Calcutta, pray for us.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:

Maureen McClay
Kay Hamill
Harry Hamill
Fr John Carlin S.J.
Sr Bridget McCourt

May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Marian Gill
Sheila Bradley
May Doherty
Helen Nash

May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:

Fíán Daniel Deeney
Ríán Canice Harkin
Róán McConnell
Kai Gillen

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Amy Doherty & Caolán McCosker
Caragh McCool & Robert Deane
who celebrated the Sacrament of Marriage recently in the Cathedral
May God bless you abundantly in love, joy and happiness

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,926
Parish Development: £1,032

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

St Therese £40
Flowers for the Altar: £40
SVdP: £60
Smile Train: £20 £10
Sight Savers: £20 £10 £20
Hungry Children: £5
Mary's Meals £200 £20
Gaza Appeal: £400

Readers for 5th /6th September

6.15pm Garth Tucker
7.30pm Liz McMonagle
9.30am Kay McGinn
11.00am Uju A
12.30pm Ursula Doherty
7.00pm Marian Boyle

Welcome Back! As the summer holidays come to an end, we wish all our children a very happy return to school. We hope you have enjoyed a wonderful summer filled with fun, friendship and happy memories.

A new school year is a fresh beginning - a chance to learn new things, make new friends and discover the gifts and talents God has given each of us. Whatever the year ahead brings, remember that God is always with you, guiding and encouraging you.

We pray for all our children, families and teachers as they begin this new chapter. May the year ahead be filled with joy, kindness, courage and many opportunities to grow.

The Padre Pio Prayer Group at Holy Family Church, Ballymagroarty, will take place on Tuesday, 1st September 2026. The evening will begin with the Rosary at 6.45pm, followed by the celebration of Holy Mass at 7.15pm. After Mass, the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St Pio while the closing prayers are recited. Everyone is welcome.

*Vol 54 No 34
Twenty- Second Sunday
in Ordinary Time
30th August 2026*

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Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13th September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Church, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Just five minutes from Derry, the IOSAS Centre and Celtic Prayer Garden is a special place of peace, community and connection. Enjoy freshly prepared homemade food in our warm and welcoming surroundings, then take time in our beautiful Celtic Prayer Garden, relax and experience its wonderful peace and serenity.

Come along, meet friends and discover somewhere truly different. Group bookings are very welcome, with ample parking and easy level access for visitors with mobility needs. Find us at F93 F104. For more information contact us at 00353 74 9384866.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

 Bulletin

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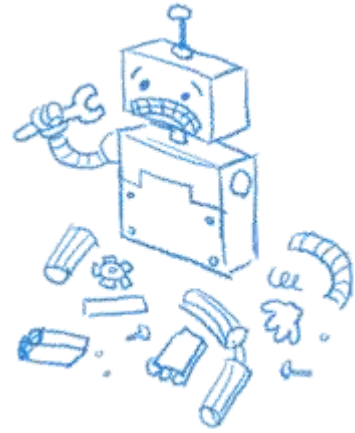
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STEELSTOWN PARISH NEWSLETTER

SUNDAY, 30TH AUGUST 2026

22ND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Faith • Prayer • Community

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 16:21–27

The Gospel today teaches us that following Jesus is not always a journey toward comfort, popularity, or worldly success. It is a journey of **surrender, sacrifice, and faithful love**.

Jesus showed His disciples that His mission would involve suffering and death before victory could come. Peter resisted this difficult truth because he wanted a safer path. Like Peter, we sometimes want God's blessings without life's burdens, a crown without a cross, and victory without sacrifice.

Yet Jesus teaches us that the greatest profit is not found in gaining more but in becoming more like Him.

Let the word PROFIT guide our reflection

True **PROFIT** is not having everything while losing ourselves. It is:

P — Pursuing God's purpose

R — Rejecting empty paths

O — Offering our lives

F — Following faithfully

I — Investing in what lasts

T — Treasuring our souls

When we choose Christ above everything else, even our sacrifices become seeds of renewal. We may lose temporary comforts, but we gain a life filled with meaning, peace, and eternal hope.

May the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ enlighten the eyes of our mind, so that we can see what hope his call holds for us.

Prayer for a New School Year

We thank you Lord, for all that was good during the summer. For the love of family and friends, and for the sunshine and warm days.

As we begin a new school year we ask for your help and pray your blessing on all our school communities. Show us how to work together for the good of all.

May we share our talents and abilities to the full and grow in knowledge, wisdom and happiness. Give us the grace to become more like Jesus in the ways we think and behave.

During this school year, let us become builders of your ways and instruments of your peace. Be with us all as we embark on this new year.

We ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, Our Lord. **Amen.**

Saints of the Coming Week

Wednesday: St Gregory the Great, pope and doctor of the Church

Thursday: St Mac Nissi, bishop

Friday: St Teresa of Calcutta, virgin

Season of Creation

1st September – 4th October

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September - 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This year's theme, '**Living Water**', invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

You are warmly invited to the streaming of World Council of Churches online service marking the World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation on **Tuesday 1st September from 1.45 – 3.00 pm** at **The Conference Room, Steelstown Church, Derry, BT48 8EU.**

For information, please contact laudatosiderry@gmail.com

RSVP: 07711900420.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt.

All welcome.

Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN** for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

All welcome.



Padre Pio Prayer Group

Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty, Derry on **Tuesday 1st September**, starting with Rosary at **6.45 pm**, celebration of Mass at **7.15 pm** followed by closing prayer and blessing with a first class relic of St Pio.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.

Visit: derryvocations.org



Donegal Group 173 – Rise and Shine Trust

Celebrating 40 Years

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating **40 years** of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter.

We are celebrating with a special Mass on **Saturday 26th September at 12 noon** in the **Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny**.

Mass will be concelebrated by **Bishop Niall Coll, Bishop Donal Mc Keown** and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years.

We invite all guests, their families and all helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Lough Derg Day Retreats

August: 31

September: 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: loughderg.org

All welcome.

St Joseph's Men's Camino

A Day of Pilgrimage, Prayer, Brotherhood and Renewal

Saturday 12th September

Step away from the demands of everyday life and spend a day walking with Christ and other Catholic men.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner)

Visit: dominicans.ie

Coffee Morning in Aid of Foyle Hospice

Join us on **Friday 25th September from 9.30 am - 12.30 pm** at **Murphy's on the Green**.

Prize draw: £1 per line.

All welcome.

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Sunday 6th September at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

The Mass will be followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie

Job Opportunity – Sacristan

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour

For application pack, please contact:

Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Telephone: 028 71262302

Closing date: 12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026.

September Men's Rosary

The September Men's Rosary will take place on **Saturday 5th September at 1.00 pm** at **Market Square, Letterkenny**.

Everyone welcome.

Pope's Prayer Intention for September

For the Care of Water

You are invited to answer the Holy Father's request and join many people worldwide in praying for the following intention:

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Cancer Focus NI – Pink Colour Fun Run

The **Pink Colour Fun Run** takes place at **Ebrington Square, Derry on 18th October**.

Details available at **cancerfocusni.org/foyle-pink-run**

† Faith • Hope • Community

Please remember in your prayers all those who are sick, bereaved, lonely or in need, and all those who have asked for our prayers.

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 30th August 2026

Twenty-second Sunday in Ordinary Time

Are your ways God's ways?

In a major shift from last week, Peter learns how difficult it can be to accept God's way. The previous few lines on St. Matthew's Gospel show Peter recognising Jesus as the Christ, while now he cannot bear to hear that the Lord must suffer, die, and rise again. To us as modern-day listeners, Jesus' reply is abrupt: Peter is thinking "not as God does, but as human beings do." It is a reminder that faith is not simply agreeing with pleasant truths; it is learning to trust God even when the road ahead includes sacrifice. Even Peter took time to realise this.

Jeremiah understands this struggle. God's word burns within him like fire, yet speaking it brings mockery and rejection and many of us know something of that tension. We want to follow Christ, but understandably we also want comfort, approval, and an easier path. We may be tempted to keep quiet, avoid difficult choices, or shape our lives around what the world expects.

Paul's letter to the Romans offers us a practical answer: "Do not conform yourselves to this age but be transformed by the renewal of your mind." Christian discipleship begins in the daily offering of ourselves to God: our time, work, relationships, worries, and hopes. This is not dramatic for most of us. It is found in forgiving someone, serving without being noticed, choosing honesty, praying when tired, or standing beside someone in our lives who is struggling.

Jesus does not ask us to take up the cross because suffering is good in itself. He asks it because love is costly, and true life is found when we give ourselves away as anyone who is married could testify. This week, let us ask for the courage to see with God's eyes and to follow Christ in one concrete choice. The cross we carry with him is never the end of the story; it is the path that leads to resurrection and life.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Broía Ferry-Buchanan**, Old Fort, **Aidah Teresa Elizabeth Callan**, Old Fort and **Darragh Adrian Devlin**, Summer Meadows

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Ann Frazer, Joan Walker, Norman Walker, Rose Henry, Joseph Sebastian, Reuven Simon, Patrick McGrath, Molly Moran, Bridget Killen, Teresa McAtamney, James O'Connell, Angela Hampsey, Eileen Quinn, Harry McClay and Maureen O'Neill

Vocations – That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention and everyone welcome.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,150.00 Strathfoyle: £490.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

Waterside Half Marathon takes place on Sunday 6 September and there will be various lane restrictions on Limavady Road, Duke Street, Clooney Road and Temple Road from approximately 7.30am until 1.00pm

“He who sings, prays twice.” (St Augustine) – St Columb’s Church will resume next weekend. We are constantly looking for new singers, maybe you would consider joining, just come along and give it a try or talk to Markus or any choir members.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year’s theme, Living Water, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God’s creation.

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. Sept. 25th/26th 2026 – Nov. 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Padre Pio Prayer Group, Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty will take place on Tuesday 1 September 2026. Starting with Rosary at 6.45pm before Mass, celebration of holy mass at 7.15pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus’ Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned’s Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Encounter School of Ministry Course but aren’t sure what it’s about or if it’s for you? Class will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 to 9.00pm beginning on 3rd September at All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham, Co. Donegal. More info or register here: <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or email donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh)
Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)

St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)
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Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

Parish Office 32 Chapel Road, Derry BT47 2BB. Tel. 02871 342303

Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

Rev. Michael Canny PP 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

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